

CHAPTER 9

Steps to Creating a Character

Here's a brief summary of the steps involved.

1. Choose and Define a Motivation
2. Choose an Archetype
3. Choose your Age and Other Identifiers
4. Choose a Path
5. Receive Your Starting Character Points
 - 5.a. 5 Points for Gifts and Burdens
 - 5.b. 42 Points for Stats
 - 5.c. 42 Points for Skills
6. Choose Gifts and Burdens
7. Determine Stats
8. Determine Skills and Skill Ranks
9. Choose an Ability
10. Determine your starting Equipment
11. Determine Derived Stats
12. Write your Background
13. Determine Initial Short and Long-Term Goals
14. Choose a Name for your Character

Note: The suggested order in this list isn't going from top to bottom on the Character Sheet. That is quite intentional. This order is done in a way that will help you build your Character step by step in a logical way. Once they are built, the order presented on the sheet will make much more sense.

Motivations

Motivations are at the core of a hero's behavior. They help you determine your Character's relationship to the story. Humans are complicated beings, so they won't always act as their Motivation suggests they might, but they will drive their hardest when following their heart. It is possible to change your Motivation later, but only as the result of completing a Long-Term Goal (more on that in the Goals and Progress Section).

Consider the core drive of your Character. What makes them tick? What gets them out of bed each day? When your Character is faced with a dilemma, large or small, why do they choose what they do? As you play, and especially as you move toward your Short and Long-Term Goals, you will use your Motivation as a guide.

» **Optional Rule:** When taking an Action, your Story Guide may increase or decrease the Success Number by 1 if you are following or contradicting your Motivation. If you think an action should be modified, let the Story Guide know and they will make the final determination.

Anything can Motivate your Character; you and your Story Guide should agree on something appropriate if not listed here. This is a short list of Motivations and a brief description for each. You don't have to use these exact definitions for your Character, but if you deviate from the below definition, you might want to note it in your Background. You can also expand or further define your Motivation using the Background or Other Identifiers section of your Character sheet as necessary.

Acceptance: You long to find true acceptance for you or someone else, from a peer group, community, or society as a whole.

Curiosity: You strive to learn for learning's sake. You are moved by knowledge and can't resist a closed door, a locked box, or an unanswered question.



CHAPTER 9

Family: Nothing is more important to you than family, whether biological or chosen.

Honor: You have a strict code of honor and strive to live up to it. What code do you follow?

Idealism: You serve a single core idea, a concept, that should be adopted by everyone. This could be anything from the elimination of poverty to survival of the fittest.

Independence: Freedom is your true calling, whether from governments or ideologies. You will fight for your own freedom and for others.

Order: You need things to be structured. You may need to impose your order on the world around you, whether it is your personal world, or perhaps everywhere.

Power: More isn't enough. You crave power — whether raw physical strength or mastery of an art, you always strive for the next level.

Control: You need to take control of part of your life as small as your own emotions or as grand as the weather itself.

Love: You are driven by the love of a person or thing, or perhaps the desire to be loved. Maybe you are searching for it. Love is at the core of all your important decisions.

Wealth: The acquisition of things and money is at the core of your being. In the end, the winner is the one with the most toys.

Status: Wealth and power are fine, but you want recognition. You want a title or an office and the praise that comes with it.

Altruism: Putting good into the world is the job and the reward. Giving, whether for charity or duty, defines your actions.

Justice: You follow an endless trail in an attempt to balance what is wrong in the world. The world is a better place because of the equanimity you strive for.

Revenge: How far will you go? What will you do if you get your chance? Your need for retribution wakes you up each morning.

Responsibility: Maybe you're taking care of a sick relative or you're on a sacred mission. It may be a burden or the fire in your soul — often it is both.

Nihilism: Not only is life meaningless, you need to prove it. Every time the universe lets you down, you feel vindicated in your beliefs.

Destiny: You believe in a greater destiny — either for yourself, your tribe or your community. It's your job to help bring it about or thwart it.

Validation: You are driven to prove and be recognized that you are either better or worse than others. Maybe you crave validation from a particular group or perhaps everyone.

Heroism: You strive to prove your bravery. Maybe just to yourself or to others. Being a hero is about recognition, even if it is just from a single person.

Protector: There are people more important than you, and you strive to be between them and danger. You feel your most complete when you sacrifice for others.

Vanity: You crave attention, adulation, fans. You're the best at everything, or at least you want people to believe that you are.

Archetypes

Archetypes can very roughly be associated as a combination of a Character's careers, aspirations, jobs, and personality. It's important to note here that this Archetype doesn't exist in-game. That is to say, if you choose Warrior as your Archetype, it doesn't mean that you have to have a violent job or your Character sees themselves as violent. Maybe you want to play a Character that aspired to be a Warrior but once they saw death for themselves up close, have chosen a different career path. Maybe they're a quiet farmer now. In the end, your Archetype is there to give you a Stat bonus, a Skill bonus, and to help you envision your Character. Don't let it box you in.

Within each Archetype, some familiar jobs are listed that exist in both our real world and in Coyote & Crow. We are also going to mention some jobs, called Key Roles, that will hopefully inspire your imagination somewhat. These are careers that are maybe rare in our real world or don't have a 1:1 comparison. They should help you get an idea about how different this world is and how you as a

CHAPTER 9

Player might view your Archetype from a different perspective.

Whatever your Character does for a job does not affect the game mechanics, but your Archetype choice is a permanent, one-time thing you will choose at Character creation. Each Archetype gives a Character a focus on a particular Stat, providing a bonus point and a Rank in a related Skill.

There are six Archetypes to choose from. There are no rules about which Archetype you can choose, but consider how the Character you are building sees themselves and how you think the world sees them. Often your Motivation can help determine your Archetype.

Warrior



Warriors focus on Strength and receive +1 to Strength during Character creation. They are often soldiers, bodyguards, and professional athletes. They are often comfortable with violence and generally solve their problems with direct physical action. Warriors receive a free Rank in Unarmed Combat or Melee Weapons Skills.

Key Role: Trail Defender. Travelers along remote routes are often troubled by bandits, animals, or other dangers. Trail defenders, often an inherited title, are known for protecting certain routes, ensuring those on the route arrive at their destination safely.

Scout



Scouts focus on Agility and receive +1 to Agility during Character creation. Scouts use their flexibility, speed, mobility, or precision in their daily life. They are runners, messengers, explorers, gymnasts, guides, archers, gamers, and more. Scouts receive a free Rank in either Stealth or Ranged Weapons.

Key Role: Seed Keeper. These people travel extensive lengths and sometimes face great physical dangers in their attempts to find, rescue, and preserve endangered strains of plants.

Tinkerer



Intelligence is the Tinkerer's focus and they receive +1 to Intelligence during Character creation. Makers, scientists, engineers, car-

penters, biologists, computer programmers, and anyone who's day-to-day work depends on their intellect are Tinkerers. They think their way through their problems and rely upon precise logic. Tinkerers receive a free Rank in either a Specialized Knowledge Skill or Crafting.

Key Role: Star Finder. Astronomers have found that with clearing skies, there is a wealth of knowledge to be discovered by looking up and asking the right questions. These people often want to travel, trying to find new, better vantage points for viewing and tracking, or experiencing new stellar phenomena.

Seeker



Perception is the focus for Seekers and they receive +1 to Perception during Character creation. Seekers range from detectives to philosophers to sociologists to bounty hunters, relying on attention to details and the uncovering of hidden things. Seekers see the world through an unusual lens and often question basic assumptions. Seekers receive a free Rank in Investigation or Tracking.

Key Role: Reality Seeker. Understanding the very nature of reality, or even realities, plural, is their goal. This role can often take the person to dark and dangerous places, put them in front of rare magics and ceremonies, have them travel to The Black, and face previously unknown spirits.

Healer



Healers are those who focus on Spirit and receive +1 to Spirit during Character creation. Healers make their way through the world with the strength of their heart and connection to the spiritual realm. Whether guiding herds, healing the sick, or acting as the moral center of their community, they have an ineffable quality. Faith and a belief in the intangible are often essential to Healers. Healers receive a free Rank in Medicine or Ceremony.

Key Role: Death Doula. When death comes, it is helpful to have someone there who can help guide loved ones in practical and spiritual matters during that difficult time. After the horrible death toll of the Awis, many felt a calling to take on a role that would help ease the suffering of survivors.

CHAPTER 9

Whisperer



A Whisperer's focus is Charisma and they receive +1 to Charisma during Character creation. Whisperers make their way through the world by sheer charm and force of will and through the manipulation or influence of others, from actors and artists to politicians and con artists. Whisperers receive a free rank in Charm or Performance.

Key Role: Mockingbird. The core mission for these people is to listen to, understand, record, and preserve stories, memorizing them if necessary. So many stories were lost after the Awis, and so many new ones are told that these individuals are driven to save every one possible. While much of their job is about convincing those they meet to share their stories, they often find themselves relaying or recreating those stories later.

Other Identifiers

This section of your Character sheet is left open for a number of optional labels for your character. We recommend you at least choose an age for your Character, remembering that only those who

have gone through adolescence will have undergone the Adanadi. This space is there for you to list:

- Your age
- Your tribe (if any)
- Your gender and/or sexuality (if you choose to specify)
- Any other labels you choose to attach to your Character that they find important

Age

As mentioned, most Player Characters in Coyote & Crow will be at least in their late teens. You are welcome to choose any age you like. Listing your age will have no affect on your Stats or other facets of your Character. However, it may help you build out your other relationships to non-Player Characters as well as to the other Player's Characters at the table.

Tribe

If you belong to a real-world tribe, feel free to assign your Character that same affiliation. Otherwise, you can skip this.

Gender

As mentioned in the Chapter “Makasing and the World Beyond,” you may assign yourself any gender you choose, including those familiar to you from the real world or Tahud.

Sexuality

Feel free to assign your Character a sexuality if you so choose and if you feel comfortable representing that sexuality in your Character. A Character's sexuality has no game mechanic effect. The people of Coyote & Crow span a broad range of human sexuality but are also much less likely to feel the

need to label themselves in any particular fashion. There is also little stigma around a person's sexuality evolving over time.

Miscellaneous

As with above, these are things that your Character believes are important to their identity but don't have a game mechanic attached to them. This might be membership in a society, a rank or title, faith or allegiance to a particular religion, or any number of other things. Feel free to get creative here if you feel the call, but anything that requires more than a short phrase should likely be part of your Background.



CHAPTER 9

Paths

A Path is a one-time choice you make for your Character and represents the type of ceremony they go through as they pass into adulthood. Paths are integral to your Character and become locked in when they receive the Adanadi. A Character's Path is often not their choice alone, as it is typical to consult with family or community by tradition. Each Path is a careful procedure combining chemistry with ceremony. Once on a Path, future Adanadi has no effect. For more on the Adanadi, see Chapter 1-7.

A Path binds the Character to an animal in a literal biological manner, through the introduction of the animal's Adanadi tissue, as well as in a spiritual and emotional way. It is a deep bond that relates to many interconnected beliefs beyond just the science of the Adanadi. Some say that you consume the essence of your Path animal and that you take on aspects of its prowess and personality. Others say that it links to the animal in a way that it will watch over and protect you. It also acts as a cultural bond to that animal.

There have been numerous studies on whether that bond is something measurable, tangible. Do Buffalo react differently to someone who is on the Path of the Buffalo? The results have been inconclusive and most claims are nothing more than anecdotal. However, the changes in a person's physiology and the human cultural effects are very real.

While there are many Paths in many cultures, below are the most common in Cahokia. Each Path affects two Stats, granting a bonus point to each at Character creation. Additionally, when you reach the Abilities step of Character creation you may choose a single Ability from one of the Path's Related Stats.



CHARACTERS

Path Name	Related Stat	Related Stat
Path of the Eagle	Strength	Wisdom
Path of the Bison	Strength	Will
Path of the Beaver	Endurance	Perception
Path of the Coyote	Agility	Intelligence
Path of the Fox	Agility	Spirit
Path of the Owl	Endurance	Intelligence
Path of the Badger	Intelligence	Will
Path of the Deer	Wisdom	Charisma
Path of the Spider	Perception	Strength
Path of the Falcon	Perception	Spirit
Path of the Snake	Spirit	Endurance
Path of the Crow	Spirit	Wisdom
Path of the Salmon	Will	Agility
Path of the Bear	Charisma	Strength
Path of the Raccoon	Charisma	Intelligence



CHAPTER 9

Character Points

The next three steps in creating your character will be accomplished through a point buying system, called Character Points. Each step has its own pool of points, as listed below. The first, Gifts and Burdens, may give you extra points for the next two steps. Each section will describe how you can apply your points and what they mean. Your starting point pools will be:

Gifts and Burdens: 5 points

Stats: 42 points

Skills and Skill Ranks: 42 points

Any unspent points from Gifts and Burdens can be applied to either Stats or Skills on a one-for-one basis. Unspent Character points are lost after Character creation.

Gifts and Burdens

Gifts and Burdens are the unique challenges, features, or resources your Character has access to or must deal with. They are often things your Character didn't choose; rather, they are thrust upon them. These aspects help define who they are and what makes their lives take the shape

they do. The Gifts and Burdens presented here are suggestions — feel free to create your own with the approval of your Story Guide. The Story Guide chapter has guidelines for building them.

A Character may have as many Gifts or Burdens as you would like, with your Story Guide's approval. Work with your Story Guide to choose options appropriate to the Saga. Gifts and Burdens are factors that are impactful to your Character's life, more so than trivial facts. By their very nature, they must be so impactful that they affect the mechanics of the game.

For example, let's say your Character has a very close relationship with their little sister. More than just having a sister, they are close with them in a way that you as a Player want to acknowledge through game mechanics. Their relationship with their sister may be a Gift, a Burden, or both. As a Gift, she could be a technological genius who helps create gadgets and gear that your Character would benefit from. She could also be annoying or dependent, always following your Character around and causing trouble or needing to be saved as a Burden.

CHARACTERS

Again, you can choose as many Gifts and Burdens as your Story Guide approves — keep in mind that these will place extra administrative restraints on both you and the Story Guide. Each of these will be something that you and your Story Guide will have to incorporate throughout your games. Consider carefully before piling them on. You can also make an idea an element of your Background rather than trying to add it as a Gift or Burden. Just because you don't take a particular Gift or Burden does not mean that an element can't be in your backstory. If your Character has a sibling or a physical quirk that has no effect on gameplay, let your Story Guide know so they can reflect it in the story.

You start the Character creation process with five points to spend on Gifts. **Each Level of Gift costs one point.** You can also accept Burdens for your Character. **Each Level of a Burden will grant you one point.** When you are finished choosing Gifts and Burdens, you must have at minimum zero points remaining. You cannot have negative points at the end of this step.

If you have points left over once you've finished choosing Gifts and

Burdens, you may add them to either your Stat or your Skill point pools on a one for one basis.

Gifts and Burdens come in three levels. Level 1 is mild or trivial. Level 2 is serious, consistent, or important. Level 3 is constant, pervasive, or critical. You and your Story Guide may need to adjust levels appropriately for your specific Saga. A character whose presence enrages buffalo would not feel burdened in an urban Saga, for example.

Take care when choosing Level 3 Burdens. These are the kinds of obstacles that will change the course of your Character's life. Taking more than one of these during Character creation is not recommended.

The same Gift or Burden may be taken multiple times in any combination so long as it makes logical sense. For example, a Player might choose to have two sisters who are extremely important in their life. One might be both a level 1 Gift and a level 1 Burden, while the other sister might only be a level 3 Burden. Families can be complicated.

In general, the Level of a Burden will equate to a change in Success

CHAPTER 9

Numbers (SN). This means a Level 2 Burden would provide a +2SN to related Checks, while a Level 1 Gift would provide a -1SN to related Checks. However, as you will see below, this isn't always the case. Additionally, you and your Story Guide are encouraged to come up with alternate mechanics and triggers for your Gifts and Burdens. For a few examples, check out the pre-generated Characters in the Encounter at Station 54 chapter.

An important note about Gifts and Burdens: Whether something is a Gift or a Burden is determined by the Player and through the eyes of the Character. Outside of the exceptions noted in the specific descriptions below, Players will decide if their Character sees something as a Gift or sees it as a Burden. For example, the Player will decide if their Character sees a relationship with their sister as either a Gift or Burden, or even both.

The Long-Term Goals section discusses how Characters can gain Gifts and overcome Burdens, even removing them in some cases. It also addresses how Players will be unable to avoid gaining new Burdens. Below is a list of Gifts and Burdens. They are described in

further detail in the following pages. The list is a broad set to get you started and to help you understand the basic concepts of Gifts and Burdens, along with their accompanying mechanics. Feel free to alter these to your Saga's specific style or to Player's needs.

- Family
- Allies and Opponents
- Financial
- Spirit World Connection
- Animal Connection
- Secrets
- Quirks
- Curses and Blessings
- Addictions
- Notoriety
- Companions

Family

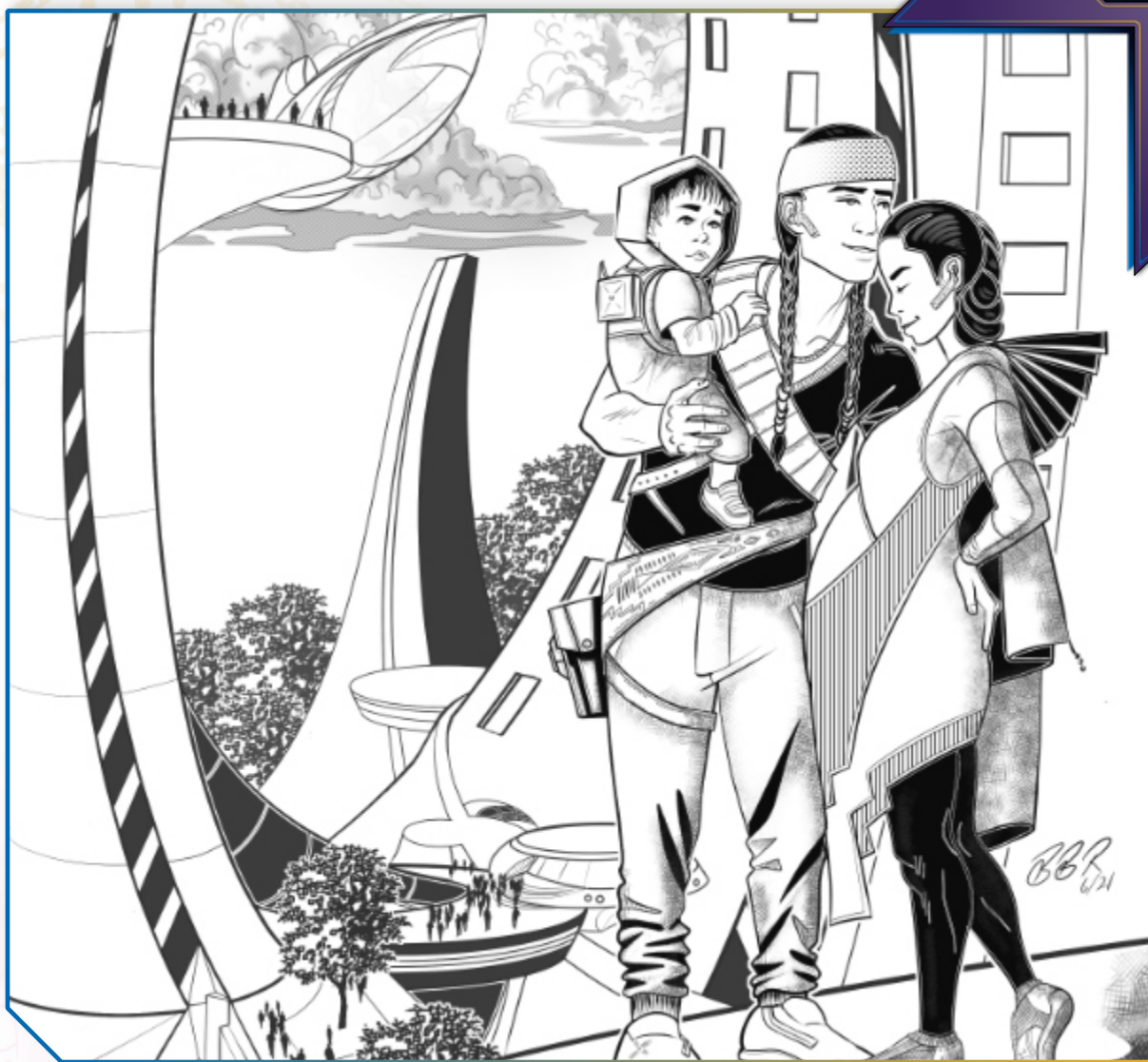
As a Gift, Family offers support, resources, and comfort. They can offer refuge, information, or any number of benefits. This may be represented by lowered Success Numbers when making Resource checks or checks to gain information. Getting a sunwing on short notice is a lot easier when your

CHARACTERS

Character's cousin has one they can borrow, and their storytelling grandma gives you an advantage when trying to find a piece of lore.

Family can also represent painful conflicts, unfulfilled expectations, psychological damage, or demands on your Character's time and emotional energy. This may be repre-

sented with increased Success Numbers in a particular type of social situation or that the Burden affects your Character's ability to focus, affecting other Skills and Stat Checks. It may mean that the needs of your family interfere with your group's goals. The Level of Burden indicates the frequency and severity of the conflict.



CHAPTER 9

Allies and Opponents

Allies and Opponents come in a variety of shapes and sizes, from your mechanic pal who will drop everything to fix your mag-bow, to the cult that you stole that idol from, to the mysterious figure who foils your plans from afar.

When you choose this Gift or Burden, give a brief description of the ally or opponent. The Level will determine how often and to what degree they help or hinder you. A Level 1 Ally either can often help in minor ways or help in an important way only under very specific circumstances. A Level 3 Opponent might always be nipping at your heels but not amount to more than annoyance or could be a massive organization that is always looming in the background, with your Character never really sure when they're going to create total havoc.

Financial

A Character who takes this Gift/Burden has either greater or lesser access to material resources than the average Cahokia citizen. Under normal circumstances, Characters start with a Wealth Rank of 4 as a default (see the Chapter

Equipment for more on Wealth Ranks). This Rank might represent actual nizi, but it might also represent access to resources through family or business interests, connections with traders or crafters, or debts owed through underground channels.

It's important to note here that unlike some other options in this section, this works differently depending on whether it is a Gift or Burden. As a Burden, each Level reduces your Wealth Rank by 1. As a Gift however, it decreases the Success Numbers on your Wealth Checks by 1. This mechanic will be explained further in the Chapter on Equipment but it's important to call out the difference between the two here.

In addition, this Gift or Burden may affect the amount of gear your Character begins with at the start of your Saga. For games set in Cahokia and similar communities, basic benefits and care are provided to everyone. It's highly unlikely that anyone living in Cahokia would have a Wealth Rank of 1 as this represents true poverty. We don't recommend you create a Character with a Level 3 Wealth Burden in your first game.

Spirit World Connection

As a Gift, your Character is finely tuned to the spirit world and The Black. To them, the veil is both nearer and more transparent — the spirit world may be a daily part of their life. Success Numbers when dealing with Spirits and the spirit world are lowered by the Gift's Level at the Story Guides discretion. This Gift does not mean that Spirits necessarily have a more positive reaction to the Character though.

Chosen as a Burden, the Character is for some reason walled off from the spiritual part of the world or they otherwise have an aversion to facing it. They may deny it even exists or be resistant to any explanations that don't put logic and science at the front and center. Any related Success Numbers are increased by the chosen Level.

Animal Connection

People with this Gift have their Success Numbers lowered by the Level for animal social interactions. They have a natural affinity for animals and can convey basic intentions more easily.

As a Burden, animals find this person unnerving or unnatural. Not only does the Character face higher Success Numbers for every Level of this Burden, but animals are more likely to attack or flee the Character, at the Story Guide's discretion.



CHAPTER 9

Secrets

Your Character has a Secret that could affect their lives in some way. Maybe it's something that would cost them their family or their job, or perhaps they would be shamed if their friends found out. Either way, a Secret must be agreed on with the Story Guide and have a consequence for the Character. While many Secrets have negative consequences, your Character may consider a Secret a Gift or having a positive side. Maybe your Character holds a secret family name that gives them access to a community or resources.

Whatever it is, when the Secret comes to light, the Character loses this Burden or Gift and replaces it with a Burden of the same level that would correlate to the exposure of the secret. Discuss in advance who else knows already and who might learn the secret without it being entirely exposed (other Player Characters for example).

Quirks

Quirks are a catch all for many things that make people unusual, whether Gifts, Burdens, or both.

Each level of this Gift or Burden will change the Success Number of appropriate Skill Checks by 1. These are intrinsic to the Character, something that cannot easily be changed. Examples of quirks include ambidexterity or eidetic memory. Essentially, Quirks can cover almost everything else that doesn't fit neatly into one of the other categories mentioned in this section. Players and Story Guides should discuss which Checks this Quirk effects.

Curses and Blessings

Sometimes people just seem to have uncanny luck, good or bad. This can be from a family charm, an evil spirit, a guardian ancestor, or a twist of fate. The Player should describe what has either cursed or blessed them and under what conditions. This fortune is limited by something — perhaps they have a good luck charm or suffer ill luck under the full moon. The Level should determine the frequency and intensity of the curse or blessing. While these can affect Success Numbers, the Story Guide may offer or accept other effects during play.

Addiction

Players may only take this as a Burden. Alternatively, your Character may receive this Burden through inappropriate use of the drugs listed in the Equipment chapter (see that chapter for details). Addiction requires that the Player choose something that the Character is addicted to. It must be something that is a physiological addiction, not just a psychological one. The Level of the Burden determines how often a Character must “feed” their Addiction. A Level 1 might be every few days, whereas a Level 3 might be at least once a day. If the Character does not get a sufficient supply of whatever they are addicted to, they will face penalties to Success Numbers equal to the Level of their Addiction for all Checks. Once they have access to their Addiction, the penalties are removed.

Notoriety

Notoriety can be both useful and intrusive depending on your Character’s viewpoint. Whether this is a Gift or Burden, however, depends on the public’s viewpoint.

When a Character chooses this Gift or Burden, they can only choose one or the other — Fame or Infamy, with Fame being the Gift and Infamy being the Burden. Fame is a positive reaction and based on the good impression the public has of your Character. Infamy is a negative reaction based on a bad impression.

The Notoriety level positively or negatively affects the Success Numbers for all social interactions the Story Guide deems appropriate. Additionally, at the Story Guide’s discretion, the Character’s Fame or Infamy can have the opposite effect if the Character is encountering an appropriate group of people. For example, if the Character chose Fame among the people of a certain nation, that Fame might act as Infamy among the people of the sworn enemy of that nation.

You can’t choose Notoriety multiple times and you must specify what you are known for and among who. No one is famous among everyone in Makasing, outside of national leaders, and they certainly aren’t always looked upon favorably.

Companions

Think carefully before choosing a Companion as a Gift or Burden. Unlike other options, Companions are fully fleshed-out lives that your Character will be responsible for. They might be a pet, a ward, an infant, or a host of other possibilities. At their core, they are Companions that are bound to your Character. Unlike Allies or Opponents, your Character and their Companion are emotionally invested, at least to some degree, and in each other's company most of the time. Your Companion will also have you as a Gift or Burden at the same level you do.

As a Gift, a Companion will be able to offer your Character their skills and resources. Even as a Gift though, a Companion requires maintenance. They have their own needs and if something bad should happen to them, your Character will feel that pain. If you choose a Burden, your Character will be hindered and delayed by your Companion. Maybe they need constant feeding or to be carried. That doesn't mean that they can't have positive aspects too. After all, there has to be some reason your Character chooses to stay in their company.

Regardless whether you choose a Companion as a Gift or a Burden, losing that Companion has severe consequences. If they die or the Character mistreats them and they leave, the Character must assume a new Burden equal to the level of this Gift or Burden. The new Burden should be agreed on by you and the Story Guide based on the relationship they lost.

You and the Story Guide should agree on what sort of Companion you have, and what sort of abilities and requirements they bring. From there, the Story Guide will craft an NPC to act as the Companion, writing out as many details as necessary (the Companion's Stats, Skills, etc). The Story Guide will play the Companion as your ally.

The Level of the Gift or Burden should reflect the value of the Companion and also the dangers. A Level 3 Gift might be a Character with Skills and Abilities equal to your own, a partner, lover, best friend, or spouse. A Level 1 Burden might be a pet bird, who often chirps loudly and at inappropriate times but can alert you to danger approaching.

Companions are great if you're playing with one or two Players but you would like to have a larger group of Characters involved in your stories.

Stats

In Coyote & Crow, a Character's Stats represent their range and capability with universal human traits. There are a total of nine Stats. Stats are generally ranked on a scale of 1 to 5.

A Stat of 1 represents a minimum level of competence, while 5 is the pinnacle of natural human ability. Most average folks have a 2 or a 3 in most Stats. It should be noted that the effects of the Adanadi can boost a stat above 5, although this isn't common. It should also be noted that anyone with a Stat of 5 or higher is going to draw attention to themselves. Anyone with a Stat of 6 or higher

must also take the Notoriety Gift at Level 1 or higher.

The three categories of Stats are **Physical**, **Mental**, and **Spiritual**. Within each of these categories are three Stats that represent various ways humans interact with that aspect of reality. The first Stat in each represents raw Power: Strength, Intelligence, and Spirit. The second is Finesse in that realm: Agility, Perception, and Charisma. The last represents our Reserves when the world interacts with us: Endurance, Wisdom, and Will.

Don't worry too much about Power, Finesse, and Reserve. These concepts do not have direct gameplay consequences. They are mostly about giving you context and a framework for how the Stats are organized. Your Stats will also determine other abilities like Defenses and Initiative, which will be discussed later.

	Physical	Mental	Spiritual
Power	Strength	Intelligence	Spirit
Finesse	Agility	Perception	Charisma
Reserve	Endurance	Wisdom	Will

CHAPTER 9

Generating Your Initial Stats

First, determine the amount of Character Points you have to spend on Stats. Each Character starts with 42 and then may add in any points they have left over from Gifts and Burdens. Second, you will buy your Stats with Character Points using this table:

Stat Value	1	2	3	4	5
Character Point Cost	0	3	6	10	15

Important! Once you have purchased your Stats through points, don't forget to add on your bonuses for your Archetype and Path. For example, Aya's Player has decided to spend 3 points on her Strength, giving her a 2. When she is finished spending points on her Stats, she adds an additional 1 because she chose Warrior, and another 1 because she chose Path of the Buffalo, giving Aya a final Strength of 4. Note that starting Stats may not go above 5 except through the points granted by a Character's Path.

Let's explore each Stat in a little further detail:

Strength

This represents raw physical power. It can directly equate to muscles, physicality, or the size of your Character's body. A Strength of 1 may represent someone who is infirm or elderly, an average adult has 2 to 3, while an athlete or bodybuilder may have a 4 or 5. A Strength of 5 indicates the peak of human physical strength and will likely draw attention to those who have it.

Agility

Agility is the accuracy of a Character's movements. It represents hand-eye coordination, but also the ability to run or dodge an attack. A fencer and a gymnast likely have higher than average agility. The terribly clumsy may have a low Agility. Someone with high Agility may excel in sleight of hand or athletics. It's important to note here that a person with a low Agility score might still have a very high rank in an Agility related Skill. For example, someone could be generally an uncoordinated person, but if you put a bow in their hand, they suddenly become deadly.

Endurance

This represents how much physical punishment your Character's body can take as well as how long they can effectively exert themselves. It affects how quickly they heal, how long they can hold their breath, and how well they fight off poison or illness. Characters with a 1 are often sickly while a 5 represents peak human resilience. These people are able to exert themselves to extreme levels and can recover from brutal injuries.

Intelligence

Your Character's ability to compute raw data and their ability to retain information is measured by their Intelligence. This is not to be confused with understanding that information, which falls under Perception or Wisdom. Someone with a 1 in this Stat would seem unintelligent even in a brief conversation. A person with a 5 seems brilliant to others, regardless of their level of education, and can comprehend complex ideas.



CHAPTER 9

Perception

Not just the ability to perceive small details, your Character's Perception also measures their ability to interpret those details and draw understanding from them. A high Perception might allow your Character to notice someone's rapid heartbeat but also if they're lying, afraid, or perhaps in love. Characters with low Perception find that they are often the last to realize anything.

Wisdom

If your Character's Intelligence is their raw processing power, then their Wisdom is the prioritization and sorting of that information. For sustained thinking, or long battles of wits or debates, Wisdom represents their ability to keep up the effort over time and to assemble disparate information into actionable concepts. Someone with a 1 Wisdom may have difficulty keeping to task or focusing their thoughts into results. A 5 Wisdom represents someone able to keep their mind working even when their body is failing and their ability to see beyond facts to greater truths.

Spirit

Spirit is the measure of your Character's presence and the force of

their personality. Characters with high Spirit seem to take up more space and their moods can be infectious, giving them a social gravity. A 1 Spirit represents someone who is not simply quiet, but meek and often missed in a crowd. Politicians, actors, social leaders, nurses, and others often have a high Spirit.

Charisma

Charisma is your Character's ability to channel their Spirit, not just infecting others with their mood, but manipulating it for maximum effect. Spirit can be used to entertain, charm, or lie, or manipulate. A Character with 1 Charisma may be uncouth or simply uninteresting. With a 5 Charisma, a character could sell socks to a snake.

Will

Your Character's Will is their sheer determination. It represents a person's ability to remain true to their character and their plans. Your Character's Will may be tested when they stand against things that make others cower, or when they are tempted by bribes or foul magics. A low Will Character would have trouble keeping their convictions, while a high Will can make them nearly unbreakable.

Skills

While Stats describe your raw potential, Skills represent what your Character has practiced and trained in. The vast majority of rolls you will make in Coyote & Crow are based on Skills. Skills will aid you in almost everything you do, from fighting to farming, from flirting to flying. Skills start at a Rank of 0 and go up from there. Some Skills you won't be able to attempt without at least a Rank of 1(as noted by an *). A Rank of 3 or higher generally shows true expertise.

For a Skill Rank of 1 or higher, you'll add your Skill Rank to the higher of the two Related Stats to get a Total. This total is what you'll use when creating a Dice Pool while playing. While there is no maximum Skill cap, we recommend that no starting Character have a Rank higher than six on any one Skill.

Many Skills can be performed at Rank 0. This means that even if you do not spend points on gaining Ranks in a Skill, the Character can still attempt to use that Skill during gameplay. If a Character attempts to make a Check with a Skill they have no Ranks in, they

must use the lower of the Skill's two Related Stats.

There are two types of Skills:

- **General Skills**
- **Specialized Skills**

General Skills are broad, covering many aspects of a subject or activity. They are common enough that they are all listed on the standard blank Character sheet. The General Skill Melee Weapons, for example, covers everything from table legs to technologically-enhanced War Axes.

Specialized Skills represent Skills that are subsets of General Skills. They are aspects of a General Skill in which a Character has extra training or knowledge. For example, a Specialized Melee Weapons Skill might be Knives. Specialized Skills are always directly connected to a General Skill. A person with a General Skill can perform a Specialized Skill at their General Skill Rank, unless the Specialized Skill says otherwise.

In order to gain a Specialized Skill, the Character must also have the connected General Skill. Specialized Skill Ranks must always be higher than their related General

CHAPTER 9

Skill Rank when first taken. For example, Aya has the Skill Piloting at Rank 1. She is best at flying Sun Wings though. Aya has the Sun Wing Specialized Skill at Rank 2, one higher than her General Skill Rank.

Note that not all General Skills have Specialized sub-Skills. Additionally, some General Skills do not give you any advantages on their own but merely grant you access to Specialized Skills. A Character also may have multiple Specialized Skills under a General Skill. Please read the specific Skill entries for details.

While many Specialized Skills are listed under their related General Skills, you can also work with your Story Guide to create new Specialized Skills. There will also be more Specialized Skills in future expansion books. See the Story Guide Chapter “Interpreting the Rules” for more on creating Specialized Skills.

General Skill List

This is the list of General Skills. This is a fixed list and should cover everything your Characters will attempt. Skills with an asterisk cannot be performed without at least 1 Rank. Specialized Skills

will be detailed in the General Skill descriptions.

Purchasing Skills During Character Creation

You have 42 points to spend, plus any points you have set aside from Gifts and Burdens. Once you’re finished spending points, add +1 Rank to whichever Skill you gained from your Archetype.

Skill Rank	General Skill Cost	Specialized Skill Cost
1	1	X
2	3	1
3	6	3
4	10	6
5	15	10
6	21	15

Example: Dezba is skilled with their war club and grew up using one. Dezba might have Skill Rank 1 in Melee Weapons, Skill Rank 2 in War Clubs (a Specialized Skill higher than their rank in Melee Weapons). When building Dezba, it would cost the player 1 point for the General Skill and 1 point for the Rank 2 in War Clubs. If they wanted to also add Knives as a Specialized Skill at Rank 3, it would cost them 3 points.

CHARACTERS

General Skill	Related Stat	Related Stat
Art	Spirit	Will
Athletics	Strength	Endurance
Ceremony*	Wisdom	Spirit
Charm	Charisma	Perception
Coercion	Charisma	Spirit
Computers	Intelligence	Wisdom
Cooking	Intelligence	Spirit
Crafting	Perception	Spirit
Cybernetics*	Intelligence	Wisdom
Deception	Charisma	Will
Farming	Intelligence	Endurance
Herbalism*	Perception	Wisdom
Husbandry	Charisma	Wisdom
Investigation	Perception	Wisdom
Knowledge	Intelligence	Wisdom
Language*	Perception	Will
Medicine*	Intelligence	Wisdom
Melee Weapons	Strength	Endurance
Music	Spirit	Perception
Performance	Charisma	Spirit
Piloting	Intelligence	Agility
Ranged Weapons	Perception	Agility
Science*	Intelligence	Perception
Skulduggery	Perception	Charisma
Stealth	Agility	Will
Survival	Endurance	Wisdom
Tracking	Perception	Wisdom
Unarmed Combat	Strength	Intelligence

CHAPTER 9

As you can see, choosing to be Specialized will cost you less during Character creation, even if it narrows what your Character is Skilled in. This will be discussed further in Progress and Goals, but it takes less time to increase the Rank of a Specialized Skill during the course of a game than a General Skill, since you are learning a more specific scope of information.

Skill Descriptions

Below is a more comprehensive description of each Skill and their Related Stats:

Art (Spirit and Will)

Artistic expression comes in a variety of forms and is essential to an advanced society. The General Art Skill cannot be used to create artistic works. Instead it is used in understanding art, artists, and forms of expression, as well as their history. Specialized Art Skills allow the Character to create new art within the sphere of their Skill. When creating a piece of art, tell your Story Guide what you want to create. Then, refer to the rules for Skill Checks Over Time.

Specialized Art Skills: Two dimensional (drawing, painting, etc.), Three dimensional (Sculpture, crafts, etc), and Writing

Athletics (Strength and Endurance)

Athletics represents long hours of focused training and a deeper connection between mind and body. A person skilled in Athletics understands their physical limitations and has a sharp sense of how to improve. Athletics is used for most physical activities like running, climbing, and playing the sports popular throughout the world. Acrobatics also helps defend against ranged attacks (see Combat).

Specialized Athletic Skills: Climbing, Acrobatics, Swimming, and Lifting along with specific sports

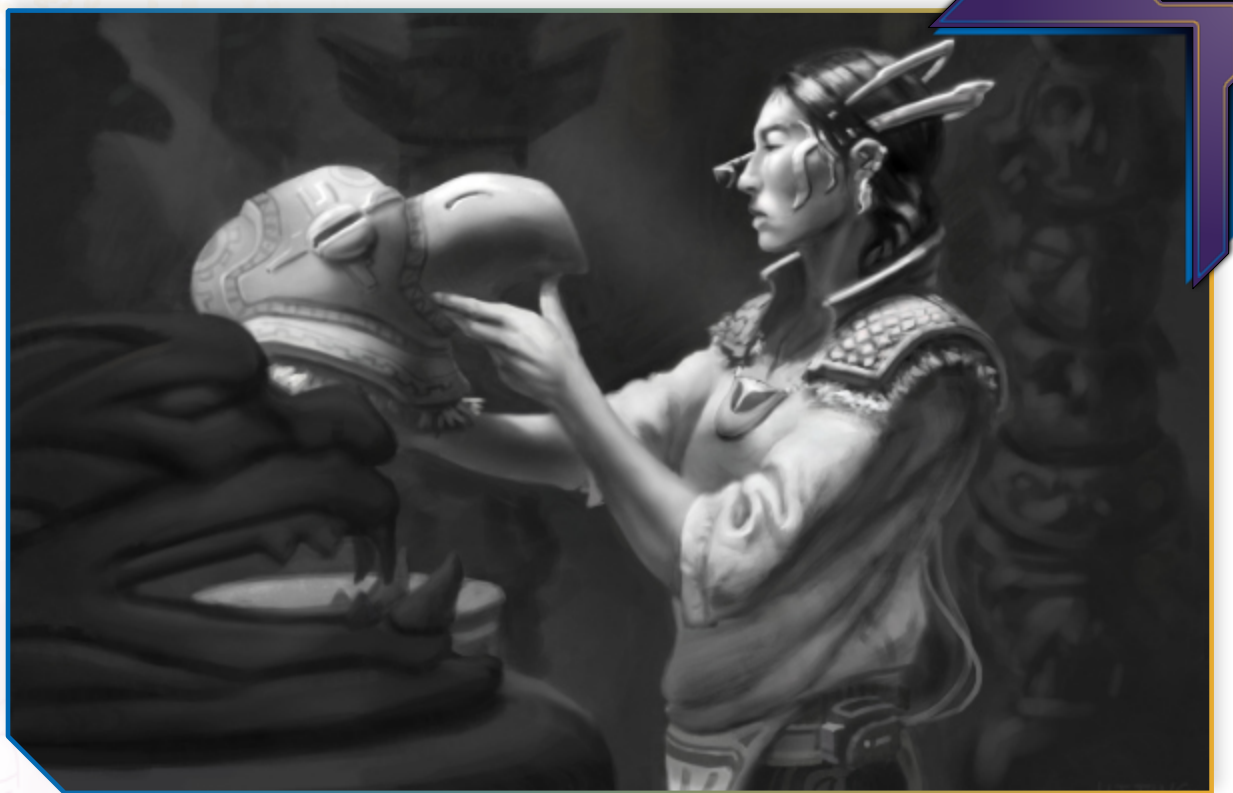
Ceremony (Wisdom and Spirit)

The Skill of Ceremony encompasses a number of religious, spiritual, and cultural traditions. Ceremonies serve a variety of purposes throughout the world. The details of ceremonies are widely varied and this Skill covers a general knowledge and the understanding

CHARACTERS

of how to take part in them. Ceremonies take a minimum of 15 minutes and often can go an hour or longer. Any number of Characters can participate in a Ceremony and all who do benefit from its results. Characters cannot take part in a Ceremony during a Short Rest, but can participate in a Ceremony — and gain the benefits — while taking a Long Rest. The Character leading the Ceremony makes the Ceremony Check and cannot begin a Long Rest until the Ceremony is completed. The Success Number for the Ceremony Skill Check is modified by the following:

- If any Character participating has a 0 rank Ceremony Skill: +1
- If more than half the Character's participating have a 0 Rank Ceremony Skill: +2
- If all participating Characters have a 0 Rank in the Ceremony Skill: +3
- If the Character performing the Ceremony has a Ceremonial Kit: -1
- If the Character performing the Ceremony doesn't have a Ceremonial Kit: +4



Note to Native Players: If you wish to replicate specific ceremonies related to your tribe, consult with your Story Guide on its difficulties, effects, and parameters. You may take that specific ceremony as a Specialized Skill. That new Specialized Skill is separate from the effects of the General Skill.

For every Success, each participant can regain a point of Mind or Soul. For example, Aya performs a Ceremony and rolls four Successes. Everyone participating can restore four points to any combination of their Mind or Soul.

The person performing the Ceremony does not gain the benefit of the participants. Instead, if they achieved at least one Success, they gain one Soul, but lose one Mind. If they gain no Successes, they lose one Soul and one Mind. If they Critically Fail, they lose one Soul, one Mind, and one Endurance.

There are no suggestions for Specialized Ceremony Skills in this core rulebook.

Charm: (Charisma and Perception)

Charm is the ability to change an NPC's disposition for the better in regards to your Character or to something your character is saying or doing. It can represent hours of conversation or witty repartee in the middle of combat. Characters actively hostile to you may be beyond swaying, though the Story Guide will let you know if a Check is allowed. We suggest that Charm not be available to be used between Player Characters, as this removes agency from Players and can affect the overall enjoyment of the game. However, we should also note that Charm, at its core, never alters consent. Indeed, Charm is the Skill that helps inform others' consent.

To use this Skill, make a Charm check with a Success Number equal to the Mystical Defense value of the target, modified as the Story Guide sees fit. To influence an NPC, they must be able to see and understand your Character. With a single Success, the NPC is more favorably inclined to whatever you were trying to convince them of, but not irrationally so. Charm cannot cause creatures to act against their own clear interest.

The number of Successes determines how convinced the NPC is, and how long they remain so, as determined by your Story Guide. In general, 1-2 Success will sway someone only briefly, while 5 or more will have a dramatic and durable effect.

Before attempting this Skill, discuss the situation with your Story Guide. Some interactions may only take a Primary Action during an Encounter, while others will fall under the Skill Checks Over Time rules.

Specialized Charm Skills: Seduction, First Impressions, Audiences

Coercion: (Charisma and Spirit)

Coercion is the attempt to bend an NPC's will and get them to take actions, change behaviors, or divulge information. It can be subtle, like a battle of wits, or straight forward, like an interrogation. Coercion at its core is an adversarial process. Unlike Charm, Coercion is an attempt at gaining a specific outcome from the target from the very start.

To use the Skill, make a Coercion Check with a Success Number equal to the Mystical Defense value of the target. The Story

Guide may increase or decrease this number based on story factors. Things like bribes, blackmail, threats, and torture all might have an effect. The number of Successes determines how much information or control you get over the NPC. The effects are generally not long-lasting. If threats or pain are used, the effects may end immediately after the results are



gained. More passive actions, like bullying a guard into thinking you are permitted access to a secured area, may last for a long time. The Player should tell the Story Guide their goal, like what question they want answered or what action they want the NPC to take, before making the check.

Specialized Coercion Skills: Diplomacy, Interrogation, Bargaining, Debating, Intimidation, Leadership

Computers (Intelligence and Wisdom)

The Computers Skill includes basic interaction with all thinking machines, niisi, home computers, and larger systems like those used by governments. Computers is also the Skill used for interacting within virtual or augmented environments, such as Second Eyes. Your Character cannot write new computer code or break into secured computers without the appropriate Specialized skills, as these require specific training.

The Story Guide will set the Success Number based on the complexity of the action. The more Successes achieved, the more rapidly the information is accessed or the more accurately the desired outcome is achieved.

Specialized Computer Skills:

Hacking, Programming (Note that these cannot be attempted with the General Computers Skill)

Hacking*: This skill permits the user to access systems and information that are protected from intrusion. The Success Number for Hacking is always higher than the Success Number for operating within the system legitimately. Critical Failures can often alert electronic security personnel or Activate additional security software, making follow-up Checks more difficult. Hacking can sometimes be time-intensive. The Story Guide will decide if a Skill Check Over Time is necessary. Hacking may also be used defensively to combat another hacker. To do so, the defensive hacker must have full authority and access over the system they are defending. If two hackers are engaged in an Encounter against each other, use the rules for Contested Skill Checks.

Programming*: Programming allows your Character to create new software over the course of hours or even years, depending on the complexity. This might reprogram how a machine operates or how it handles data. Programming fol-

lows the Skill Checks Over Time rules. Your Story Guide will let you know the interval and Success Number.

Cooking (Intelligence and Spirit)

Cooking allows your Character to take ingredients and create cohesive, delicious meals. This Skill takes a minimum of 15 minutes and can be used during a Long Rest. When the Character creates a meal, they make a Cooking Check; if they achieve at least 1 Critical Success, anyone consuming that meal during a Short or Long Rest will gain back an extra point of Soul. The Success Number of Cooking checks may vary greatly depending on the availability of ingredients, the amount of time the cook has, and the amount of help. Cooking by themselves for six other people out in the wilderness is a tall order, while cooking in

a stocked modern kitchen with a full staff is substantially easier.

In addition, a Successful Cooking Skill Check may reduce the Success Number of related Healing, Medicine, Ceremony, or even social Skill Checks, such as Charm or Coercion, at the Story Guide's discretion.

Specialized Cooking Skills: Foods of a particular tribe or region



CHAPTER 9

Crafting (Perception and Spirit)

Crafting allows your Character to create or repair things. These can be things that already exist, such as a shed, a vehicle, or a weapon, or entirely new things that have never been seen before, putting the Character in the role of inventor.

Simple Crafting under the General Skill allows a player to competently use a gat and woyi or more traditional tools to make basic items and to assemble them. These include any items that have only the Body and Endurance Stats (see the Equipment section for more). This kind of Crafting is almost always done as a Skill Check Over Time, although in certain situations a Story Guide might allow some improvisation during an Encounter. The larger a thing is, the longer it will take. The more complex it is, the higher the Success Number will be.

If something has Stats other than Body and Endurance, it likely has complex parts, like a mag-bow. In this scenario, a Crafter must have a Specialized Skill in order to craft that thing. These Specialized Skills are generally broken down

into broad types. Waterborne craft, bows, sunwings, etc.

For the creation of entirely new items, see the Skill Checks Over Time section. You will also have to have the Skill related to the item you are trying to invent. You can't craft a new drug without the Medicine Skill or create a new type of plow without having the Farming Skill.

When repairing items, the degree of access to replacement parts and the level of damage to the item will determine the Success Number. Most repairs are done as Skill Checks Over Time. A Story Guide may decide that an item is beyond repair.

Specialized Crafting Skills: There is a long list of potential Specialized Crafting Skills, but we suggest using the Categories in the Equipment chapter as a starting place.

Cybernetics* (Intelligence and Wisdom)

Cybernetics allows Characters to identify and safely install or uninstall cybernetic equipment, directly connecting human flesh to non-biological components. Note

that while this incorporates knowledge of Biology, Medicine, Crafting, and Computers, it is its own separate Skill. Your Character does not need those Skills to have this one, nor does having Cybernetics allow them greater knowledge of those Skills. Someone might know how to cut a person open and install a synthetic liver, but it does not mean that they have an understanding of what the liver does or how to build the synthetic version, both of which would be covered by other Skills.

Before taking this Skill, it is important to note that attitudes about cybernetics — and the people who use and install them — vary wildly. Many see them as distasteful or unnecessary. Others even see them as a violation of natural laws.

Specialized Cybernetics Skills: Internal Organs, Sensory Implants, Limbs, Dermal, Neurological

Deception (Charisma and Will)

Deception is about being able to tell convincing lies, verbally or visually as well as detect them. It might be an intricate falsehood, little white lie, or sleight of hand.

These uses would be immediate during social Encounters. The Skill can also be used over long periods of time as when performing a cover up or fraud, utilizing the Skill Check Over Time rules. To use the Skill, the Player rolls a Deception Check with a Success Number equal to the Mental Defense of the target NPC. The Story Guide may increase or decrease this number based on story factors. The Player must specify the Deception prior to making a Dice Pool check and explain what they expect from the outcome. At the Story Guide's discretion, this attempt may be treated as a Contested Skill Check.

Specialized Deception Skills: Disguise, Sleight of Hand, Impromptu Lying, The Long Con

Farming (Intelligence and Endurance)

Farming is still one of the most common Skills in Cahokia. While large-scale farms operating with robots and drones are becoming more prevalent, for most, growing your own food to sustain a healthy diet for your family isn't just a tradition — it is a part of daily life. Most families and neighborhoods have gardens and small urban

CHAPTER 9

plots that are regularly maintained. It is also important to remember that farming is the key Skill in creating base chemicals for gats. This means that farming isn't just about eating, it is also about materials production.

Farming allows you to operate machinery, understand the effects of weather and seasonal cycles, crop rotations, and provides a basic understanding of the plants you're growing, as well as pest control.

Specialized Farming Skills: Gardens, Industrial Farming, Roots and Tubers, Flowers, Fruit, Seeds and Corn, Leafy Vegetables, Stem Vegetables

Herbalism* (Perception and Wisdom)

Herbalism covers producing teas, smudges, poultices, and other sim-

ilar items. It is any use of a plant outside of sustenance for an effect. Proper use, consumption, preparation, and dissemination of herbs have a variety of positive effects. A Critical Failure with Herbalism can produce unintentional Poison Effects at the discretion of the Story Guide, while a Failed Check simply produces no positive effect.

When gathering or purchasing materials, the Player must declare the effect they are intending to achieve. Herbal concoctions may affect either Body, Mind, or Soul. Your Character may make a Herbalism Check to create a concoction which can be used during a Long Rest. If your Character achieves any Successes, then the Character who consumes the concoction during a Long Rest gains one additional Success in a Check to recover Body, Mind, or Soul. A Character can only consume one concoction per Rest.

Herbalism can act as a substitute for the Medicine Skill when treating Body Damage if the damage has a Sub-Type. The Character would treat their Herbalism Skill as a Medicine Skill Check with a +1 to the Success Number.

Herbalism can also be used to create or counteract Poisons.

Native players: You can take specialized Herbalism skills, drawing from your own culture's traditions. Work with your Story Guide on the details and mechanical effects you wish to achieve.

Specialized Herbalism Skills: Poisons, Body, Mind, or Soul concoctions.

Husbandry (Charisma and Wisdom)

Stewarding animals is an important part of most communities. This Skill includes relating to, raising, breeding, training, and communicating with animals. Husbandry also includes population control and understanding mating and seasonal habits, understanding migration patterns and safe numbers of a species to kill for food, as well as the proper ways to slaugh-

ter them. Husbandry provides your Character enough understanding of animal behaviors to read their intentions and allow them to convey their own intentions toward that animal to a lesser extent.

Some animals (rats, dogs, birds, squirrels, others with Story Guide approval) can be trained to understand specific verbal or hand commands with the Skill Checks Over Time rules. See the Chapter “Interpreting the Rules” and the Companion entry in Gifts and Burdens for more.

Specialized Husbandry Skills: Specific species.



CHAPTER 9

Investigation (Perception and Wisdom)

Investigation allows your Character to understand meanings and implications from what they sense or detect around them. Investigation allows your Character to gain information from the Story Guide with a Successful Check. For example, if the goal is to determine if a room had been disturbed since the Character last saw it, a single Success might give a feeling that someone had been there. Multiple Successes might get much more specific as to how the room was disturbed or who had been there based on physical evidence.

The Story Guide may lower or increase Success Numbers based on the investigating Character's other Skills and their relation to the Investigation. Characters are allowed to make Investigation Checks again if they have Failed the Check, but this involves adding additional time and energy into the investigation; the Story Guide will determine how much longer the following check takes and may increase the Success Number. A Critical Failure on Investigation may lead to false clues or misleading information.

Note that Investigation does not include Tracking, which is a separate Skill.

Knowledge (Intelligence and Wisdom)

Knowledge is an unusual Skill in that, as a General Skill, its only real purpose is to give your Character access to Specialized Skills. You can think of Knowledge as having a foundational understanding of learning. You can only take 1 Rank in Knowledge. From there, all of a Player's choices will be from a list of Specialized Knowledge Skills. These Specialized Skills are acquired through higher education, personal discovery, reading, listening to elders, or just paying close attention to the world around you.

Some things that you might assume fall under Knowledge may instead be under Science or other Skills.

Knowledge of a specific subject may give the Character a bonus when it comes to certain other Skill Checks as well. A Character attempting to Bargain might get a decrease to their Success Number if they were using their Knowledge of Business to better understand the merchant's needs.

Specialized Knowledge Skills: Examples include: History, Politics, Religion, Folklore, Anthropology, Archaeology, Sociology, Psychology, Marketing, and Business

Language* (Perception and Will)

Similar to Knowledge, the Language General Skill can only be taken as high as Rank 1. This gives the Character a general understanding of linguistic structures. Even without this Skill, all Characters in the game are fully versed in Chahi and Plains Sign Language. Additionally, if your Character is from a real-world tribe, they can also speak that language fluently without spending any Character Points.

Taking Specialized Skill Ranks in Language allows for your Character to speak and read additional languages. Each Language is its own Specialized Skill. Each Rank in that Skill gives you an idea of how skilled you are. A Rank 2 is equivalent to light conversation. Rank 3 is skilled in reading, writing, and speaking. Rank 4 is totally fluent in that language. Rank 5 and higher reflects a mastery of localized dialects, historical aspects of the language, and would allow you to act as a professional translator.

Learning a new language during gameplay without being around a native speaker as a mentor takes twice as long per Rank as other Skills. For more on this, see the section on Goals and Progress and the subsection in that Chapter on mentors.

Medicine* (Intelligence and Wisdom)

Medicine covers a range of science-based and traditional medicines. With a more holistic approach, most people see Medicine, Herbalism, Ceremony, First Aid, and even Cooking as part of a greater whole — keeping the body, mind, and spirit in a unified, healthy state. The General Skill Medicine is focused on healing the physical body (Body Damage). However most practitioners of Medicine and people who think of themselves as Healers specialize in either Physical, Mental, or Spiritual aid.

A Character may not make Medicine Skill Checks during an Encounter or while taking a Short or Long Rest, only during Narrative Play. A Medicine Check can bring a living Character with negative Body up to zero or heal 1 point of Body. To bring a Charac-

CHAPTER 9

ter with negative Body to zero, your Character must achieve a number of Successes equal to the number of Body that would need to be healed. For example, if their patient was at -3 Body, it would take 3 Successes to help them. With enough Successes, the target heals to 0 Body. To heal a patient who is at zero or above health, your Character must roll as many Successes as their current Body. If they were at positive 4 Body, it would take 4 Successes to heal them an additional Body point. At zero Body, the healer must score one Success.

A Character can only make one Medicine check on a specific Character once a day. Alternatively your character may treat an Effect, removing it with a Successful Check. If your character takes a Specialized Skill, they may also treat certain Stat Damages. A patient may only recover 1 Stat point per day through Medicine checks, in addition to what they recover from Long Rests.

Specialized Medicine Skills: Physical Medicine (Strength, Agility, and Endurance), Mental Medicine (Intelligence, Wisdom, and Perception), and Spiritual Medicine (Spirit, Charisma, Will)

Melee Weapons (Strength and Endurance)

Melee Weapons Skill allows for the proficient use of any simple handheld weapons in combat. There are some complex weapons that require specific training and require a Specialized Skill.

Specialized Melee Weapons Skills: Knives, Axes, War Clubs, Spears, Anicha Blades*.

Music (Spirit and Perception)

The General Skill of Music, similar to Art, only includes a general understanding of the history and significance of music, the instruments involved, and current trends in music, including popular musicians. It does not allow your Character to play an instrument or sing. To perform or create new music, you must take a Specialized Skill. A Specialized Skill will allow a person to create original music and replicate other compositions with that instrument.

Music is important in Makasing and is more than just entertainment. It helps bind communities together and is seen as a bridge to communicating with ancestors,

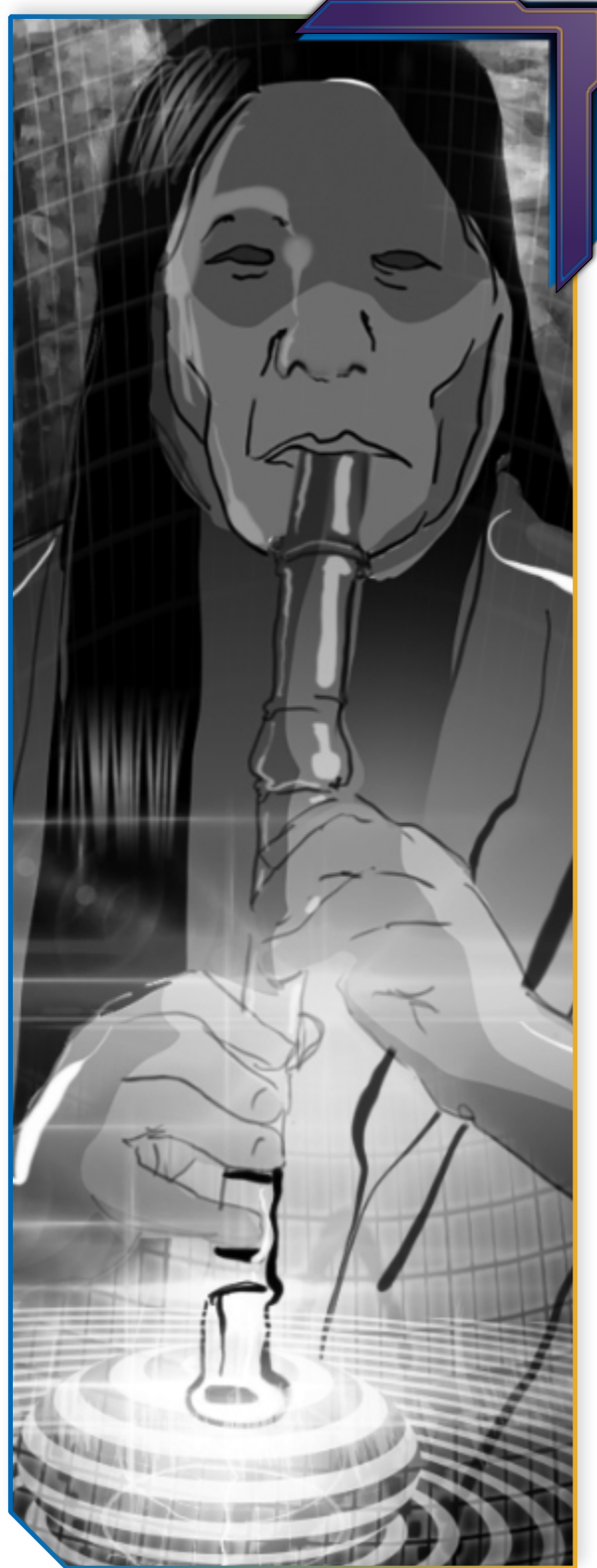
spirits, and gods. A Successful Music Skill Check can lower the Success for others making Ceremony, Leadership, Charm, Performance, or Survival Checks. It's not limited to those things though — feel free to discuss with your Story Guide how a Successful Music Check might affect other Skill checks or Abilities.

Specialized Music Skills: Drums, vocals, synthesizers, flute, rhythm sticks, rattles, etc.

Performance (Charisma and Spirit)

Performance is about getting in front of a group of people and entertaining them. It is the ability to captivate, inspire, make them laugh, and make them think. This skill covers dancing, oration, storytelling, comedy, and any performing art not covered in another skill.

When rolling a Performance Check, the greater the number of Successes you have, the more you have wowed your audience. Additionally, a solid performance can affect other subsequent Skills Checks. For example, a Successful Performance Check could lower the Success Number on a Cere-



CHAPTER 9

mony Check or Charm Check. For the most part, this Skill is only used during Narrative Play. If you wish to use it during an Encounter, discuss it with your Story Guide first.

Specialized Performance Skills: Comedy, Dancing, Oration, Costuming, Storytelling, Acting

Piloting (Intelligence and Agility)

Piloting includes any powered vehicle with modern controls as well as more traditional forms of travel, like canoes and sleds. Most modern vehicles in Makasing have similar controls. Whether it's

yutsu barges, sunwings, or a custom skimmer, Piloting allows your Character to power the vehicle up and control its speed, acceleration, arc, pitch, and yaw. Skill Checks aren't required for everyday use if you have any Ranks. Instead, checks are only required for extreme maneuvers, during Opposed Skill Checks, or any other time that the vehicle is put to the test. If you have 0 Ranks in piloting, you can still pilot vehicles but must make Checks even for basic maneuvers.

Specialized Piloting Skills: Air Vehicles (like sunwings), Land Vehicles (like Mag-Barges), Water Vehicles (like Skimmers), Drones.



Ranged Weapons (Perception and Agility)

Being Skilled in Ranged Weapons allows your Character to wield a variety of deadly weapons that do damage from afar. This includes thrown weapons, bows, mag-slings, and any other weapons that attack at a distance.

Specialized Ranged Weapons

Skills: Mag-bows, mag-slings, traditional bows, spears, thrown knives, or any other specific ranged weapon.

Science* (Intelligence and Perception)

Science enables your Character to learn the Skills necessary to discover new information and to help better understand the world around them. The General Skill gives you an understanding of scientific principles and a general history of science without any specific knowledge within specialized fields. Science Specialized Skills can be used to perform experiments and to recall information related to your field of study. This can overlap with the Knowledge Skill in some cases; the difference is that this Skill isn't just being able to recite facts or

history, but to apply that knowledge to the Character's own scientific endeavors. It allows for the understanding and use of the equipment used in the corresponding fields as well. Using the Skill Checks Over Time rules, Characters may make new discoveries and scientific progress.

Specialized Science Skills:

Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Astronomy, Geology, and more

Skulduggery (Perception and Charisma)

Skulduggery encompasses a wide range of unscrupulous behavior including picking locks, running scams, breaking and entering, getting a hold of secretive information, administering poisons, and of a variety of talents in a criminal's skill set. It is the Skill of the con, the thief, and the assassin. Where there is overlap between Stealth, Deception, and Skulduggery, the Story Guide will decide which Skill or Skills can be used. If multiple options are available, the Player may choose.

When your Character wants to use Skulduggery against an NPC, the Story Guide will determine the Success Number, usually the tar-

CHAPTER 9

get's Mental Defense. Successes determine how convincing or skillful the attempt is while a Critical Failure will expose the Skill user. When used to target an object, such as a lock, Critical Failure sets off an alarm or otherwise makes the situation worse. Some uses of Skulduggery may fall under Skill Checks Over Time, like a con.

Specialized Skulduggery Skills:

Disguise, Picking Pockets, Hiding, Lock picking, The Word on the Street, The Long Con

Stealth (Agility and Will)

This Skill allows the user to move unseen from place to place and to approach enemies unaware. If a Character begins the situation unseen, they make a Skill Check to determine how hidden they are or how unnoticed they will go. A Standard Success Number is 8, or if against a specific NPC, that person's Mental Defense. The Success Number can be modified by the following:

- Bright Lighting: +1-2
- Open Area: +1-2
- Small groups of people or light surveillance: +1
- Crowds or heavy surveillance: +2

- Dim Lighting: -1
- Cluttered area or light foliage: -1
- Dense foliage or heavy cover: -2
- Total Darkness: -3

If the Character is already visible to others and wants to become hidden, the Perception of the viewer is added to the Success Number. A person who is actively scanning for a hidden target makes an Investigation Check. The Success Number is equal to 7 plus the number of Successes the Stealth user achieved.

Specialized Stealth Skills: Urban Stealth, Wilderness Stealth

Survival (Endurance and Wisdom)

This Skill covers a broad range of knowledge and practices. Staying alive in hostile environments is a product of resourcefulness and determination. It allows you to scrounge for food in a rocky barren area, find safe passage in a raging fire, know how to create shelters in a snowstorm, where to protect yourself from a freezing wind, or how to find water in a desert. The more extreme the environment, the higher the Success Number. A Success keeps the

CHARACTERS

Character from suffering from environmental damage. How often the Character has to make a Survival check depends on the severity of the environment and the Character's exposure. Walking in a blizzard might require a Survival Check every mile the Character travels, while a zero oxygen environment might be every Round. Failure indicates your character is unable to adjust to the environment, suffering the appropriate consequences. A single Character with this Skill can help protect

others. For every person the Skilled Character is attempting to protect in addition to themselves, they add 1 to their Success Number.

Survival also allows for Players to make First Aid checks. For more on First Aid, see the Chapter "Damage, Healing & Death."

Specialized Survival Skills: First Aid, Specific Environments (Desert, Forests, Mountains, etc.)



CHAPTER 9

Tracking (Perception and Wisdom)

Tracking allows your character to follow someone or something, or figure out where they've gone. It is important to distinguish Tracking from Investigation. While Investigation might allow someone to piece together abstract and varied pieces of evidence to make a conclusion about where someone has gone, Tracking is about being able to notice minute evidence of a person's physical traversal, often footprints, tracks, or other direct, observable means.

Successes determine not only whether you are able to follow your target but how quickly you advance on their trail. The Story Guide will secretly keep track of whether you are getting enough Successes to keep pace or gain on your target. A Failure indicates you cannot move or have not found their trail. You may try again after an interval determined by the Story Guide. A Critical Failure indicates you are headed in the wrong direction, led astray by false clues.

Specialized Tracking Skills: Urban Tracking, Wilderness Tracking

Unarmed Combat (Strength and Intelligence)

This Skill allows your Character to be effective at defending themselves and harming others using only their body. If engaged with another opponent using Unarmed Combat, your Character may defend themselves by adding their Rank of Unarmed Combat to their Physical Defense against a single opponent as a Secondary Action (see Defend). If being attacked by multiple enemies, you may divide your Character's Ranks up to protect from multiple attacks as their sole Secondary Action. Otherwise, the raised Physical Defense only counts against a single attacker also using Unarmed Combat. The General Skill reflects standard, closed fists punches, basic kicks, and a general melee knowledge.

Each Specialized Skill offers unique advantages:

Martial Arts: Each Rank in Martial Arts allows the Character to convert one die in their Pool to a Critical Die prior to their initial Check. Martial Arts must be learned with a teacher or during Character creation. Ranks in Martial Arts higher than 2 require the

Player to take on the Ally Gift, as the Character requires a dedicated teacher in order to advance the Skill. This may be taken at the time of Character creation or later, as per the Goals and Progress section. The teacher must always have Ranks of Martial Arts equal to or greater than the student, which makes Martial Arts teachers very valuable and in high demand.

Wrestling: Wrestling is about using your own body weight and leverage to out maneuver and control an opponent's body, pinning them or restraining them, leaving them vulnerable to injury and restricting their movement. In order to affect an opponent with Wrestling, a Character must have Control over the target. Once they have Control, Wrestling allows the Character to activate either or both of these effects:

Restricted Movement: The Controlled Character may not take the Move Secondary Action. The Controlling Character may only take it as a Secondary Action, bringing the Controlled Character with them.

Damage: The Controlling Character may cause Body Damage to

the Controlled equal to their Strength or their Wrestling Rank (Controllers choice) as a Secondary Action. This Damage may be Lethal or Non-Lethal.

To gain **Control**, a Character needs to make a Wrestling Dice Check, gaining as many Successes as the opposing Character's Total Wrestling Dice Pool. This can be a standard Primary Action, or the result of a Contested Skill Check if both Characters are Wrestling each other. (See Contested Skill Check rules for more.)

Once gained, the Controlling Character can keep Control each Round as a Primary Action without making any more Checks. If they choose not to keep Control, they automatically lose it and may take Actions normally.

The Character under Control has extremely limited options for Actions. The Controlled Character must decide which of these they are attempting before making a Check.

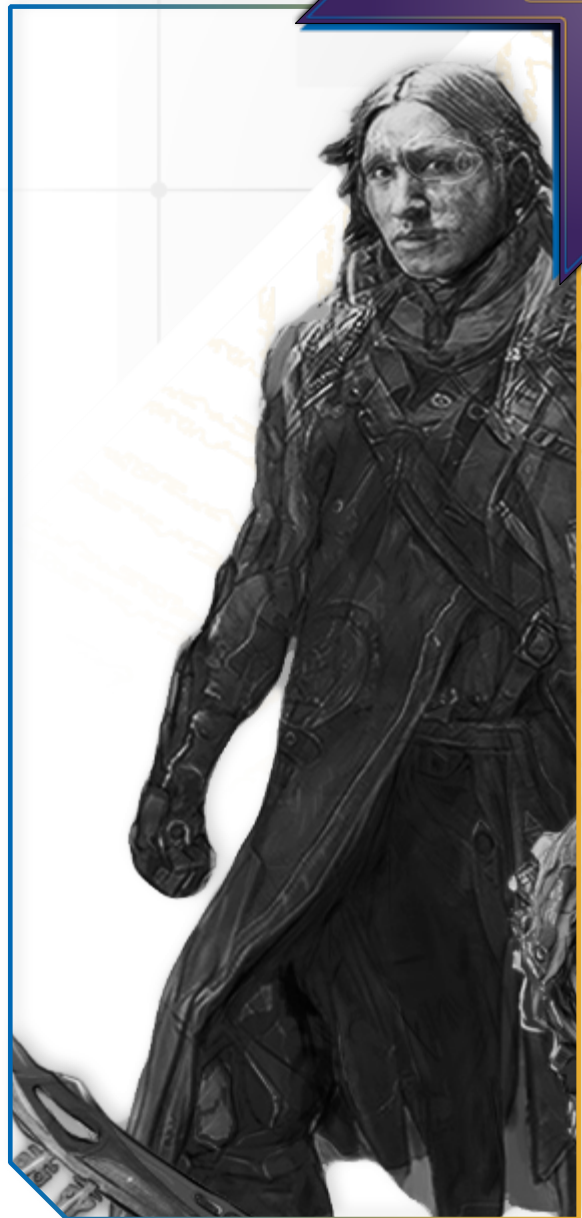
Break the Control: This requires a Primary Action and a Wrestling Check with a number of Successes equal to the Controlling Character's Total Wrestling Dice Pool. If Successful, they are free of the Control.

CHAPTER 9

Reverse the Control: This requires a Primary Action and a Wrestling Check with a number of Successes equal to the Controlling Character's Total Wrestling Dice Pool plus one Critical Success. If Successful, the Controlled and Controlling Character switch.

Other Attacks: They can also attempt to make other attacks (Melee or Ranged) against the Controlling Character or others, but the Success Numbers of those attacks is increased by the Wrestling Skill Rank of the Controller.

Brawling: Brawling is fighting dirty. Brawlers go out of their way to fight in a manner meant to cause maximum injury to their opponent at any cost, even their own defense. Brawlers will bite, scratch, and use any dirty trick they can find. Brawlers also use their Rank in this Skill when wielding improvised weapons, allowing them to attack with whatever random items are available — a chair leg, a bowl, anything — to attempt to maim an opponent, granting them +1. Brawlers lower the required Success Number by one for every Rank in Brawling they have. Failures (not just Critical Failures) from Brawlers often



result in injured allies, damaged equipment, or even injuries to the Brawler themselves. While using Brawling, a Character is not allowed to use the Defend, Take Cover, or Dodge Secondary Actions. Brawling cannot have a Rank higher than 3.

Abilities

Abilities are the superhuman powers your Character gained during adolescence when their Adanadi Path was chosen. Only 15-20% of people receive an Ability when they choose their Path. Those who gain Abilities sometimes develop additional Abilities, but this is rare. Those who do not immediately show signs of an Ability are not generally known to gain them later in life.

Every Player Character starts out with one Ability from their chosen Path. The Ability can be chosen from either of their Path Related Stats. Players may gain further Abilities through Long-Term Goals (See Character Growth).

The Abilities listed here are the most commonly seen in the Cahokia region. Characters from other parts of the world may have different Paths and Abilities.

Abilities have a cost to use as well as guidelines about when they can be used. Some Abilities can only be used during an Encounter, while others are only during Narrative Play or during Rests. Many are a mix.

Abilities don't display themselves the way powers do in superhero comics. They are usually more subtle; oftentimes people can use their Abilities without anyone even knowing they are being used. There are some exceptions to that and they will be called out in their descriptions.



CHAPTER 9

Ability Name and Related Stat	Ability Short Description
Strength	
Power of the Bear	Increase Strength with Will Check
Skin of the Armadillo	Upgrade Physical Defense with Charisma Check
Warrior's Fire	Upgrade Damage With Mind
Agility	
Cougar's Grace	Increase Agility with Wisdom Check
Arrow's Wish	Increased odds of Success with Ranged Weapons with Mind and Soul
Chameleon's Shine	Increased Stealth with Spirit Check
Endurance	
Gecko's Heart	Increased Endurance with Soul
River's Flow	Adapt physiology with Mind
Winter's Rest	Additional Healing Will and Spirit Check
Intelligence	
Eagle's Insight	Substitute Intelligence for other Stats with Mind
Wasp's Sting	Make Mental Attacks with Intelligence and Spirit Check
Stone Thoughts	Increase resistance to mental effects with Intelligence and Will Check
Perception	
Hawk's Eye	Improve senses with Soul
Raven's Call	Telepathically communicate with Soul
Quiet Mind	Increase Mind through meditation
Wisdom	
Read the Earth	Gain Insights with Wisdom and Endurance Check
Mother's Voice	Relinquish control to a greater power
Far Sight	Remote sensing with Wisdom and Perception Check
Spirit	
Walk the Black	Travel in spirit form with a Will Check
Mender's Touch	Heal others with Spirit and Will Check
Ancestor's Storm	Spirit and Charisma Check to give Mind and Soul to allies
Charisma	
Mountain's Inspiration	Charisma Check to inspire people, giving them future Successes
Coyote's Gaze	Imposed empathic connection with a Charisma and Perception Check
Deer's Smile	Calm a group, forestalling violence with a Charisma and Will Check
Will	
Wolverine's Resolve	Regenerate Soul during an Encounter
Spirit's Covenant	Extraordinary luck, good and bad
Owl's Watch	Improved Reaction Rolls with Mind

Opposite is a summary of Abilities and a short description of each. Full descriptions can be found below.

Strength Abilities

Power of the Bear

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 Point of Soul

Dice Check: Will

Your Character can temporarily increase their Strength. To Activate, the Character spends a Secondary Action, 1 point of Soul, and makes a Will Check. For each Success, the Character's Strength increases by one. When the Character's Strength goes up, all related Dice Pools (Skills, other Abilities) increase as well. Derived Stats such as Body, do not.

The additional Strength lasts until the end of their next Encounter or they take their next Rest, whichever comes first. The maximum their Strength can be increased is twice their normal Strength Stat. If a Character does not increase

their Strength to the maximum amount during one Round, they may make a subsequent attempt the next round, adding further to their Strength until they reach their maximum.



CHAPTER 9

Skin of the Armadillo

Activation: Primary and Secondary Action

Dice Check: Charisma

With this Ability your Character makes their skin tougher and thicker than normal, protecting them from Physical Damage. Your Character spends a Primary and Secondary action to Activate the ability and makes a Charisma Check. For each Success, the Character's Physical Defense is increased by one for one hour or until the end of the next Encounter, whichever comes first. The Character may make subsequent Checks, and each Success adds to their Physical Defense to a maximum of twice the Character's Charisma.

If your Character gets a Critical Failure when activating this ability, they lose all but one point of Soul and will be unable to attempt to use Skin of the Armadillo again until they have completed a Long Rest.

Warrior's Fire

Activation: Secondary Action, 2 Points of Mind

Dice Check: None

Once per day, your Character may choose to go into a fierce rage, allowing them to upgrade damage from any Strength based attack. Activating the Ability is a Secondary Action and costs 2 points of Mind. When Activated, the Character adds one Critical Die to their Strength-based Dice Pools for the rest of that Encounter. Until deactivated, the Character must make Strength-based attacks as their Primary Action if possible.

The Character may Activate the Ability in subsequent Rounds, building their rage, adding an additional Critical Die each time. The Player can Activate the Ability a number of times per Encounter equal to their Strength.

Your Character cannot hold back attacks or use Focus to lower dice results while Warrior's Fire is active. If no opponents are available, they must continue to attack, targeting allies or bystanders if necessary. They can avoid attacking for one Round with a Will Check as a Secondary Action. If a Character can make three Successful Will Checks in a row, they may end their rage.

While they are raging, your Character cannot fall Unconscious.

Once the rage ends, if they have 0 or fewer Mind, they immediately fall Unconscious. At 1 or more Mind, they cannot make Dice Checks until they have taken a Short or Long Rest and they will be in a listless daze.

Agility Abilities

Cougar's Grace

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Mind

Dice Check: Wisdom

With this Ability, your Character can temporarily increase their Agility. To Activate, the Player spends 1 point of Mind, a Secondary Action, and then makes a Wisdom Check. For each Success, the Character's Agility increases by 1. When the Character's Agility goes up, all related Skill Pools and Abilities increase as well. However, Derived Stats, such as Body, do not.

The Agility boost lasts until the Character's next Rest or the end of their next Encounter, whichever comes first. The maximum their Agility can be increased is two times their normal Agility Stat.

Arrow's Wish

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Soul, 1 point of Mind

Dice Check: None

This Ability grants your Character extraordinary skill in striking targets at a distance. To Activate the Ability, they use a Secondary Action, and spend 1 Soul and 1 Mind. During the next Ranged Attack Check this Round, all dice showing values between 2 and 6 may be flipped to their opposing sides prior to spending Focus or using Legendary Ranks. Fails cannot be modified by this Ability. If you are not using physical dice, here are the values that the dice may be changed to:

- 2 becomes 11
- 3 becomes 10
- 4 becomes 9
- 5 becomes 8
- 6 becomes 7

CHAPTER 9

Chameleon's Shine

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Soul

Dice Check: 2x Spirit

When this Ability is Activated, your Character becomes harder to see. They aren't truly invisible, but close. Rather than objectively making the Character harder to see, this Ability affects the minds of those around them so that the user of the Ability is less likely to be noticed, except perhaps out of the viewers peripheral vision.

To Activate Chameleon's Shine, Characters spend a Secondary Action, spend 1 point of Soul, and roll a Dice Pool equal to twice their Spirit. For others to see a Character who is using this Ability, the Success Number is equal to the Character's number of Successes, plus their Ranks in Stealth. This applies to all forms of organic vision, even those with technological assistance like goggles or cybernetics, as the Ability directly affects the brain. However, electronic sensors that operate without an organic component, such as an alarm with a heat sensor trigger

or a motion detector, will be unaffected by Chameleon's Shine.

Characters may make a Perception Check as a Secondary Action each Round to keep track of a Shined Character if they have been seen. If they don't Succeed, they do not know the Character's position and cannot attack.

Successes gained through the activation of this Ability are also added to your Character's Physical Defense while they are Shined. If the Shined Character actively interferes with or attacks another Character in any way, they pop back into full visibility and the Character must re-Activate the Ability on a subsequent Round in order to use it again. The new Successes replace the previous result.

If Shined outside of an Encounter, the Character must spend 1 additional point of Soul per hour past the first to stay hidden. If knocked Unconscious, this Ability ends. This Ability also ends at the end of an Encounter unless the Character spends an additional point of Soul.

Endurance Abilities

Gecko's Heart

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Soul

Dice Check: None

This Ability allows your Character to increase their Endurance, enabling them to run farther, hold their breath longer, survive poisons longer, and even survive life-ending Physical Damage. There are two ways a Character can use this Ability, either out of an Encounter or during an Encounter.

Out of an Encounter, your Character may spend Soul points to add to any Check involving Endurance, adding one die for each Soul point spent. If the roll is a Skill Check Over Time, they must spend an additional Soul per hour.

During an Encounter, the Player may Activate this Ability as a Secondary Action by spending 1 point of Soul. When they do, their Spirit Rank is added to their Endurance until the end of the Encounter. This affects all related scores — Physical Defense, Body, Skills, etc.

Once Activated, each point of Soul used on Fortitude counts as

2 points for the duration of the Encounter.

When this Ability ends, your Character's Spirit score is reduced by 1 until they've completed a Long Rest. Characters may Activate this Ability during multiple Encounters before a Long Rest, but each time the Encounter ends, they will lose another point of Spirit.

River's Flow

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Mind

Dice Check: None

With this Ability your Character may alter the way their own body behaves, down to the cellular level — it can change everything from heart rate to organ function to musculature.

Activating this Ability costs a Secondary Action and 1 point of Mind. It may be used in or out of an Encounter.

The Character may add one die to any roll involving a chosen Physical or Mental Stat for that Round (Strength, Agility, Endurance, Intelligence, Perception, Wisdom). This doesn't change their Stat nor

CHAPTER 9

does it affect Derived Stats, it simply adds one die to their Pool for that roll.

In addition, your Character can use this Ability to modify their physiology. There are a wide variety of uses for this but here are a few examples:

- Instantly fall asleep, even when circumstances might make it normally difficult.
- With a Primary Action, slow or stop blood flow in an area, canceling the Bleeding Effect.
- As a Primary Action, accelerate the body's healing process. The Character may gain one point of Body this way per day. They may use this function even if they are at zero Body.
- As a Primary Action, slow pulse and breathing, allowing the Character to hold their breath for an extended time. Add Perception to Endurance Checks.
- Mimic death. Add Endurance to Performance checks for mimicking death.
- Control their involuntary muscles to manipulate their facial structure, making them harder to recognize. Add Will to Disguise Checks at Story Guide's discretion.

Other effects as determined or approved by the Story Guide.

Your Character can only use River's Flow for one effect at a time. If a Character is unable to focus or is otherwise distracted as determined by the Story Guide, they must make a Will Check to Activate this Ability.

Winter's Rest

Activation: Secondary Action

Dice Check: Will and Spirit

When your Character Activates Winter's Rest as a Secondary Action, they fall into a deep slumber that could be mistaken for death. They cannot be roused, even by Physical Damage, until at least four hours have passed and are unaware of what is happening in the world around them.

After four hours, they get the benefit of a Long Rest. In addition, they make a Check based on a Dice Pool of their Will and Spirit. For each Success they achieve on their Check they recover additional points in Body, Mind, or Soul, spent in any way they choose. Any Critical Successes may instead be used to recover lost Stat points or remove Effects such as Disease or Poison.

Using this Ability does not count as taking a Long Rest and a Character who has used this Ability may take a Long Rest and gain the full benefits from it even after they have just awoken from using this Ability.

Intelligence Abilities

Eagle's Insight

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Mind

Dice Check: None

This power allows sudden keen insights into situations, things, and opponents. This Ability has two uses, depending on whether it is used in or out of an Encounter. If

used out of an Encounter, your Character may spend a point of Mind to substitute their Intelligence for any other Stat when making a Skill Check.

During an Encounter the Character may spend a point of Mind and a Secondary Action to study an opponent. On the following Round, they gain an additional die to any Dice Check against that opponent. The Character may stack this Ability on a single opponent with a maximum number of additional dice equal to the Character's Perception.

All bonuses for any target are lost after the Character takes a Long Rest.



CHAPTER 9

Wasp's Sting

Activation: Primary Action, 1 point of Mind

Dice Check: Intelligence and Spirit

The Character may make a purely mental attack on a target with a number of potential effects. This Ability is controversial among many people in Makasing. Making a direct mind to mind attack has opened up an ongoing discussion in scientific, philosophical, and religious communities. Players should be aware that the open use

of this Ability may have social, and legal backlash against the Character (see the section on the Adanadi for more).

Your Character may target Humans, Spirits, or Creatures within Short or Medium Range with this Ability. To Activate this Ability, the Character spends a Primary Action and a point of Mind, and rolls a Dice Check equal to the Character's Intelligence plus Spirit. The Success Number is the Mental Defense of the target. The number of Successes determines the effects.



- Critical Failure: Psychic backlash. Your Character loses 3 points of Mind and is Stunned.
- Failure: Your Character loses 1 point of Mind
- 1 Success: No effect.
- 2 Successes: The target loses 1 point of Mind
- 3 Successes: The target loses 2 points of Mind and is Stunned
- 4 Successes: The target loses 3 points of Mind and is Stunned
- 5 Successes: The target loses 4 points of Mind and is rendered Unconscious
- 6 Successes: The target loses 6 points of Mind and is rendered Unconscious
- 7 Successes: The target loses 8 points of Mind, is rendered Unconscious, and loses 1 Stat point from the Mental Attack chart
- 8 Successes: The target loses 10 points of Mind, is rendered Unconscious, and loses 2 Stat points from the Mental Attack chart (rolled separately)
- 9+ Successes: The target loses 12 points of Mind. If this reduces them below 0, they face Instant Death. Regardless, they are rendered Unconscious and lose 3 Stat points on the Mental Attack Chart.

After using this Ability, your Character cannot gain points of Mind through a Short Rest until they have taken a Long Rest. Other ways of regaining Mind (Skills and other Abilities) will work.

Stone Thoughts

Activation: Reaction Roll

Dice Check: Intelligence and Will

Stone Thoughts allows your Character to wall up their mind and thoughts to defend themselves from natural and supernatural effects. The Ability has a number of uses both in and out of Encounters.

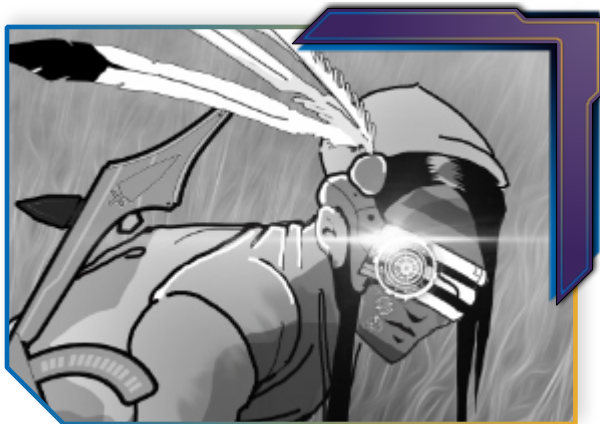
During Narrative Play, your Character can spend 1 point of Mind per hour to protect themselves passively. While Active, they are immune to the following Abilities: Far Sight, Chameleon's Shine, Raven's Call, Deer's Smile, and Coyote's Gaze. In the case of Far Sight, the Character can still be seen and heard remotely, but the Far Sight user cannot target the Stone Thoughts user as their point of sensory origin. Stone Thoughts cannot be used selectively. It's either on or off in Narrative play and the mental wall will not allow any of these Abilities through.

CHAPTER 9

In addition, social Skills (Charm, Coercion, Deception) used against the Character have a +4 Success Number.

During an Encounter, your Character may Activate Stone Thoughts as a Reaction Roll when someone is using any of the above Abilities or Skills. Activating the Ability costs 1 point of Mind. Your Character rolls their Intelligence plus Will — each Success adds 1 to their Mental Defense for a full Round.

When this Ability is active, your Character becomes extremely good at performing tasks that require singular focus as the user becomes very difficult to distract. This may, at the Story Guide's discretion, lead to a reduction in Success Numbers for Skill Checks like Lock Picking or aiming a weapon when they might otherwise face penalties for distractions.



Perception Abilities

Hawk's Eye

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Soul

Dice Check: None

Your Character can greatly increase their Perception to supernatural levels. Outside of an Encounter, they may spend points of Soul to use Hawk's Eye to increase their Perception at a one for one rate. The maximum increase a Character can receive is double their base Perception score. This lasts one hour or until the start of their next Encounter. During an Encounter, they may Activate the Ability once per Round, spending a point of Soul to increase their Perception by 1. They may repeat this over multiple Rounds until they have doubled their initial Perception. The Ability deactivates and the Character's Perception returns to normal at the end of the Encounter. The use of this Ability improves Related Skill Checks. It does not affect Derived Stats, such as Mind.

If a Character's Perception is over 5 while using this Ability, more than five total Successes may

grant them temporary access to senses beyond normal human range. At the Story Guide's discretion, they may detect invisible Spirits, see into the infra-red, learn the owner of an object, detect a nearby Character in The Black, or gain other extraordinary insights beyond normal human capabilities. The Character does not choose these extra insights and they do not remain consistent between Ability Activations.

Characters who raise their Perception above 5 with this Ability are vulnerable to being overwhelmed. Anything particularly loud, bright, or otherwise causes an extreme sensation may be treated as an attack that can cause the Character to become Stunned.

Raven's Call

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Soul

Dice Check: Perception and Spirit

Using Raven's Call connects the Character's mind to the minds of others, allowing them to communicate with people across long distances or plant subtle suggestions in their subconscious. Activating this ability costs 1 point of Soul and a Secondary action. Once Ac-

tivated, Your Character Checks a Dice Pool of Perception plus Spirit. The Success Number of the Check can be modified by a few factors.

- User:
 - Is in an Encounter at the time of Activation: +2
- Target:
 - Friend: -3
 - Enemy: +3
 - Is in an Encounter at the time of Activation: -1
- Range:
 - Within sight: -1
 - Hundreds of miles away: +1
 - Thousands of miles away: +3

Your Character can connect to one person's mind with a single Success. Each additional Success allows them to connect to an additional person and to link those two people to each other. This connection can be kept as long as your Character takes no Primary actions. Your Character cannot benefit from Rests while using this Ability. The connection allows for verbal communication between connected parties as though they

CHAPTER 9

were in the same room, regardless of distance or whether they can communicate verbally outside of this Ability.

A Character cannot connect to strangers unless they can see them. Once a Character has connected to a mind, they can reconnect without them being in sight.

If your Character gets a Critical Success they may plant a suggestion into one target's mind. The target must then make a Successful Will Check with a Success Number of 7+ the number of Critical Successes your Character achieved. If they don't Succeed, they must attempt to carry out your Character's suggestion. Suggestions can be short term ("Push the red button") or long term ("Seek me out"), but it must be simple, no more than a few words. The target will naturally incorporate this idea into their actions as long as it does not directly threaten their own safety. Once the target has completed the suggestion, they will feel confused or befuddled. The target does not become aware the suggestion was artificially planted. If your Character Critically Fails an attempt to plant a suggestion, the target will be aware that someone has at-



tempted to invade their mind, although they will not be automatically aware of who it was.

Warning: The people of Makasing consider planting suggestions in others' minds to be a violation of consent. It's considered rude at best and a severe violation of personal autonomy at worst. And even the communication function of this Ability has raised more than a few eyebrows. Players should consider carefully before planting suggestions in the minds of others and whether they want their minds linked. Players and Story Guides may opt for the suggestion aspect of the Ability to be unavailable in their Saga. For more on how this Ability is perceived in Makasing, see the section on the Adanadi.

Quiet Mind

Activation: None

Dice Check: None

By assuming a meditative state and taking no other actions, a Character may focus their mind and apply incredible potency to whatever Dice Checks they attempt later on. This meditative state can be a chant, a dance, a trance or any other focused repetitive state the Player would like, but must remain consistent across uses. When they enter the meditative state, they begin increasing their Mind by 1 every ten minutes. The Character can stay in this state for as long as they would like; however, their total Mind cannot go above an amount equal to their standard Mind total plus twice the Character's Charisma.

The Character will keep the bonus Mind points until they are spent, until the end of the next Encounter, or until they take their next Long Rest. Once a Character has left their meditative state, any attempts to enter another one will not yield any results until the Character has had a Long Rest.

Example: Aya has a normal pool of 10 Mind and a Charisma of 4. Her maximum benefit from this Ability would raise her Mind to 18 ($10 + 2 \times 4$).

Wisdom Abilities

Read the Earth

Activation: 2 Mind

Dice Check: Wisdom and Endurance

This Ability can give the Character profound and valuable insights about the world around them, information they might be hard pressed to come by otherwise. This information is gleaned through a vision obtained while in a trance-like state. The information is often not literal and is given to the Player by the Story Guide through a description of the vision, which is often a series of cryptic images or a dreamlike experience.

Some people say that this is a supernatural Ability, while others claim that it is tapping into either the deep subconscious or even some form of collective consciousness. Either way, while the information described to third parties might seem highly subjective, users of the power claim that the information is detailed and accurate if you know what to look for and how to interpret the images.

CHAPTER 9

To Activate the Ability, the Character must be in a calm state, comfortable and sitting in a preferred position. The Player then spends 2 points of Mind and performs a Check with a Pool equal to the Character's Wisdom plus Endurance. The Success Number can go up or down depending on the surrounding circumstances. For example, utter silence, a raging storm, a bleeding injury, or mind altering drugs might all affect the Success Number by a point or two at the Story Guide's discretion.

Once Activated, the Character goes into a deep trance and can only be awakened before the end of the vision by causing the Character Damage or by physically dragging them out of their meditative stance. If removed from the trance early, the effect ends with no visions and the Character must start again.

Prior to making their Check, the Player should tell the Story Guide what they want to learn. It should always be phrased as a single question and not of the yes or no or otherwise binary variety. The Story Guide may respond with anything from a single word to a short story (more on this in the

Chapter "Interpreting the Rules"). Their response will always have relevance and never be misinformation.

The number of Successes a Character achieves determines two things. First is the length of the trance. The more Successes, the longer the trance. This length of time is not directly correlated to the length of description provided by the Story Guide. One Success might be less than a minute while more than five might be a full day. The Story Guide will decide the actual length of time.

The second effect Successes have is the amount of information that the Player and their Character can interpret from the visions.

- **Critical Failure:** The Character misinterprets the images and comes to an incorrect conclusion. The Player and Story Guide should work together to come up with this false narrative that the Character will believe fully.
- **Failure:** The Character cannot make any sense of the images and they become indistinct and foggy when the Character leaves the trance,

- **1-2 Successes:** The Character understands a singular piece of information about their question.
- **3-4 Successes:** The Character gets the answer to their question
- **5+ Successes:** The Character gets a detailed answer to their question and even some vague clues about the greater context around the question.

Questions should be specific, but again, not binary. They should be relevant and actually important to the Character. If the power is used as a party trick, false visions will appear. They shouldn't be too grandiose either. Asking about the meaning of life could lead to some really disturbing and indecipherable visions. Instead, keep questions on point but with room for the Story Guide to expand.

Example: Aya has Read the Earth and can't find Dezba. She's attempted to track him but has lost his trail. Using Read the Earth, she might ask, "Where has Dezba gone?" The Story Guide might have a variety of answers depending on the number of Successes Aya rolls on her Check. "South." "South by Southwest, traveling by Sunwing, a day's lead on you." Maybe even "South by Southwest, traveling by Sunwing, a day's lead

on you. You see a skyline that doesn't look familiar, but you're pretty sure you could draw it."

Additionally, users of Read the Earth will sometimes get additional imagery as well, visions that have nothing to do with their asked question but may be relevant to the Character in other ways. This is discussed further in the Story Guide section.

The Mother's Voice

Activation: Primary Action, 2 Mind

Dice Check: Charisma and Spirit

Some see this Ability as tapping directly into a deep level of instinct while others claim it is surrendering your will to a higher power or being guided by your ancestors. Regardless, when Characters use this Ability, their conscious mind seems to take a back seat and something else takes over, helping them to accomplish a task or feat. Something that directs them in a way that often leads to unexpected or potent results.

This Ability can be used in or out of an Encounter. Activating this Ability costs a Primary Action and

CHAPTER 9

2 Mind. When the Character chooses to Activate The Mother's Voice, the Player describes to the Story Guide a Primary Action or general result they are attempting to achieve that involves a Dice Check of some sort. They then create a Pool from their Charisma plus Spirit and convert three of the dice to Critical Dice rather than building it from whatever Pool they normally would. The Dice Check then continues as normal. Once the number of Successes is determined, the Story Guide will interpret the actual actions the Character took, using the Successes gained from the Ability roll. For example, if the Player intended to use Investigation in a room to find clues, the Story Guide might have their Character walk out of the room and out into a field to provide answers, using the Successes from the Ability Pool rather than an Investigation Check.

If used outside of an Encounter, the Story Guide retains control of your Character until they decide to return it to the Player or when the basic intent the Player originally stated is concluded, whichever comes first. Once the Story Guide gives control back, the Character is

Stunned but when they come out of it will gain 1 Mind.

If used during an Encounter, each Round after the first the Player may decide to turn it off. If they do, the Character is Stunned. During the following Round, they may act normally and will gain 1 point of Mind. While active, the Story Guide will determine the Character's Actions for each Round and the Player will repeat the Ability Check process. The Ability shuts off automatically at the end of an Encounter.

Far Sight

- » **Activation: Primary Action, 2 points of Mind**
- » **Dice Check: Wisdom and Perception**

Far Sight allows your Character to see, hear, and experience their natural senses from distant locations or through people they are familiar with. To Activate this Ability, your Character spends 2 points of Mind and a Primary Action(if done during an Encounter). They choose their target, either a place or a person, then make a Dice Check with a Pool equal to their Wisdom plus Perception. While using this Ability, the Character is consid-

CHARACTERS



ered Stunned and unable to take other normal Actions or receive any of their own sensory information. They appear to simply stand staring off into the distance.

The base Success Number is modified by various factors:

- Places:

- They are intimately familiar with the area. It's their home or a place they see almost daily. -4
- They know the area very well. It is in the city they live or an area they've visited regularly. -2
- They've Successfully used Far Sight at the location at least 3 days in a row. -1
- They have only been to the location once or twice or seen it from afar. +2

- They have only seen it in video or pictures. +4

- People:

- They are emotionally close to the target - lovers, friends, comrades, close family, etc. -4
- The target is an acquaintance. -2
- The Character has a significant possession of the target. -2
- The Character has Successfully used Far Sight on the target for at least 3 days in a row. -1
- The Character has met the target only once or seen them in multiple videos. +2
- The Character has only seen a single video or picture. +4
- The Character has never seen the target. +6

CHAPTER 9

Each Success allows your Character to choose one basic sense. They can then remotely receive sensory information from their target. If they have chosen a location, then the information comes from a single invisible floating point with a good view of the space. If the Player chose a person, they are limited to the sensory information that the person has (eg. you can't choose to see through someone who is blind).

Once the senses have been chosen they cannot be changed without starting the process over. Your Character may keep the connection going as long as they choose. The Character cannot receive any personal sensory information from their own body or move while using this Ability. They may however make a Will check, with a Success Number of 9 as a Secondary Action. If Successful, they may verbalize up to a few sentences about what they are sensing to others. One Success might just be a word, while four or five could be complete sentences.

Spirit Abilities

Walk The Black

Activation: 1 point of Mind, 1 point of Soul

Dice Check: Will

Walk the Black allows a person to leave their body and move around in a spirit or astral form, staying either in the physical world or traversing over to The Black. Doing this takes focus and concentration and can only be done outside of an Encounter. While the user is out of their body, their physical form is motionless and considered Unconscious.

To Activate the Ability, the Character sits or lies down, and spends a point of Mind and a point of Soul. They then make a Will Check. A Success indicates they have successfully Activated the Ability. When the consciousness leaves the body, the Player decides whether they stay in reality or traverse to The Black.

If they choose to keep their essence in reality, the Character makes a Charisma check. Every Success allows the Character access to one sense of the Player's Choice. If the Character gets six

CHARACTERS



or more Successes, they may receive supernatural sensory input (see Hawk's Eye). Staying in reality in this form requires total focus and every hour the Character must make another Charisma Check, choose their senses again, and spend a further point of Soul and Mind.

While in this form, they can travel unseen or heard and are entirely incorporeal. However, they can still be detected with five or more Successes on a Perception Check from another person. The Character

cannot interact with the real world except to receive sensory input. They can move at no more than a slow walking speed and can pass through walls, floors, or any physical substance. Their essence cannot take Body Damage, but may take Mind or Spiritual Damage.

Alternatively, the Character may choose to travel to The Black. In this scenario, their essence leaves this plane and travels to a different realm of reality. For more on The Black, see the Chapter "Playing Coyote & Crow."

CHAPTER 9

While using Walk the Black, Characters may not use Fortitude and can take no action that would affect their physical body. It is essentially an empty vessel. However, if either their essence or body dies, they both do.

No matter how far they are from their physical form, Characters may return to their body in a single Round by making a Successful Charisma Check as a Primary Action. Once they have returned to their body, the Character wakes up the following Round Stunned. For every full hour they are out of their body, they temporarily lose 1 point of Endurance. They automatically regain 1 point back lost in this fashion per Long Rest. If reduced to zero Endurance while using Walk the Black, the person perishes as their body becomes untethered from their spirit.

Mender's Touch

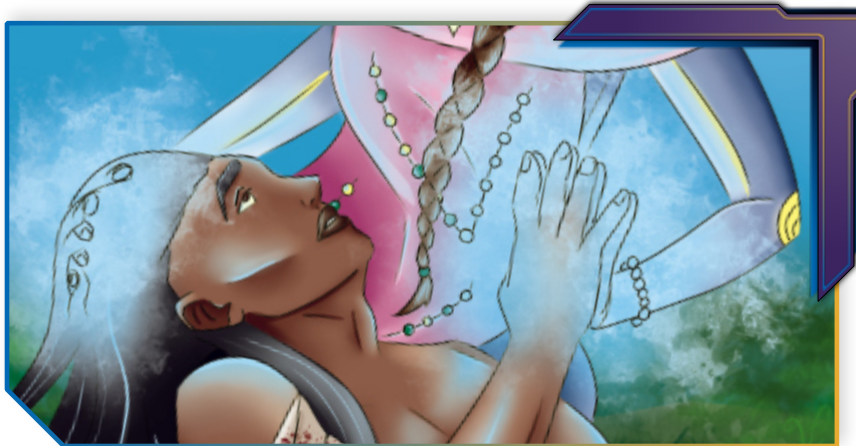
Activation: Primary Action, 1 point of Mind, 1 point of Soul

Dice Check: Spirit and Will

Mender's Touch allows your Character to heal the Physical Damage of one or more Characters. To Activate, the Character must spend a Primary Action, 1 point of Mind, and 1 point of Soul. The Mender must be either sitting or lying down and be totally focused. They may not perform any Secondary Actions while using this Ability.

Once Activated, the Character may spend any amount of Soul. For each point spent, they can heal 1 point of Body Damage done to another Character that they are touching or connected to. Once they've spent all they have chosen to, the Player rolls a Pool based on their Character's Spirit and Will.

For every Success, they may heal another point of Body Damage. Critical Successes allow the Player to choose to heal 2 points or to heal a point of Stat Damage. One point of Damage



is healed per minute, during which time the Character may take no other Actions. The Player decides how to disseminate the points of healing they have generated in any fashion they choose, but they cannot heal themselves.

Once all points have been distributed, each Fail rolled during the Pool Check costs the Character 1 point of Soul. This means a Player should be careful about how many points they give out at the beginning of the activation through Soul, as it is possible for a Mender to literally die healing others.

Ancestor's Storm

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Mind, 1 point of Soul

Dice Check: Spirit and Charisma

This Ability allows the Character to summon an inner strength — many believe directly from their ancestors — and pass it on to their allies. This Ability can only be used during an Encounter. Activating it costs a Secondary Action, 1 point of Mind, and 1 point of Soul. Players Activating this Ability often trill, shout, chant, dance, or have other ways of displaying the Activation — the Character must be able to engage in their preferred

method as a Secondary Action for the Ability to work. The Player then rolls a Check based on Spirit and Charisma. For each Success they receive, they disperse 1 point to a Character of their choice within sight. They cannot take these points for themselves. The recipients then add that point to their Mind or their Soul, whichever the receiving Character chooses. If the Player using the Ability rolled any Critical Successes on their Check, they give themselves 1 point of Soul for each Critical Success.

In subsequent Rounds, the Player may continue to use the Ability, spending another Secondary Action and another point of Soul, rolling their Pool again and dispersing points again. Mind and Soul Points gained from this Ability may exceed the target's normal maximum, but all excess points are lost at the end of the Encounter.

At the end of an Encounter where this Ability was used, the Character is Stunned. If this Ability is used in a second Encounter before the Character has had the chance to take a Long Rest, it will cost the Character 2 Mind and 2 Soul for each Activation. A third Encounter would cost 3 each, and so forth.

CHAPTER 9

Charisma Abilities

Mountain's Inspiration

Activation: Primary Action, Secondary Action, 1 point of Soul

Dice Check: Charisma

With this Ability, your Character can make other people better just by being around them. Similar to the effect of well-loved leaders or performers, this Ability can bring out the best aspects in others. In effect, they can give Successes on Dice Checks to others by inspiring them.

To do this, the Player spends a point of Soul, as well as a Primary and Secondary Action if used during an Encounter. The Character then chooses a target Character and a specific Stat, Ability, or Skill that the target possesses. The Player then rolls a Charisma Check. Each Success gained is then applied to the next Dice Check the target makes that utilizes that Stat, Ability, or Skill. While this is happening, the Character is praising and empowering the target verbally or through other direct communication.

A Character can't be targeted by more than one use of Mountain's

Inspiration at a time. If targeted again, the previous bonus is lost. If the target rolls a Critical Failure on any Check before using the Successes granted by the Ability, they lose them.

Example: Holata Activates her Ability, praising Dezba's Ability with his war club, specifying his Melee Weapon Specialized Skill, War Clubs, just before an Encounter. Making a Charisma Check, she gets 3 Successes. The next time Dezba makes a Dice Check with that Skill, he will add 3 Successes to anything he rolls.

Coyote's Gaze

Activation: Secondary Action, 2 points of Mind

Dice Check: Perception and Charisma

Coyote's Gaze creates an extreme level of connection and empathy between the Character and another Character they can communicate with. This ability is an incredibly dangerous power and Players and Storytellers should be cautious in how they apply it to their gameplay. Your Character has control over this connection in a way that allows them to easily manipulate the target. It can sway

an argument, make a stranger your friend, or create interest in the Character where there was none before. It is important to note that this Ability does violate the target's consent and goes beyond the Charm Skill. The Ability only works on human beings and does not affect animals or spirits. It may or may not work on Creatures.

Coyote's Gaze is frowned upon in most social circles, is often against the law for public use, and is forbidden in official negotiations. It can also lead to additional criminal charges under Cahokia laws if used in a way that causes harm to someone through its use.

To Activate this Ability, the Character chooses a target they can see directly and spends a Secondary Action and 2 points of Mind. The target performs a Check with their Will and adds Successes to their Mental Defense. The result is the base Success Number for the Character using Coyote's Gaze. Then add in any of the following modifiers.

- If the Character using the Ability:
 - Is injured: +1
 - Can only speak to (in a shared language) or see the target, but not both: +1
 - Is an enemy or perceived as an enemy by the Target: +2
- If the Target:
 - Is already angry at the Character: +2
 - Attacked your Character during the current Encounter: +1
 - Was attacked by your Character in current Encounter: +3
- The Character then makes a Check based on a Pool of Charisma and Perception. The number of Successes determines the effect of the Ability.
 - **< 0:** The target becomes angry and is aware the Character is attempting to manipulate them.
 - **0:** No effect
 - **1-2:** The target considers your Character a friend and potential ally or lover. Target will not act against their own interest or betray loyalties, but will attempt to maintain the Character's favor.
 - **3-4:** The target is putty in the Character's hands. They will betray friends, fight for them, quit their job, or leave their family if the Character asks.
 - **5+:** The target worships the Character. They will kill or die for them without hesitation. They will do anything to please your Character and will become violent and beyond reasoning if rejected.

CHAPTER 9

The duration of this Ability is left to the sole discretion of the Story Guide as a way to curb abuse. When the duration is up, there will be a gradual lessening of the effect. Once completely free, the Target will either be anywhere from bewildered to horrified depending on how they behaved while under this influence.

Warning: This Ability should be used sparingly, if at all, against Player's Characters without prior discussion and agreement from all parties, as having agency taken from a Player can result in a less enjoyable gaming experience.

If a Player's Character is subjected to this Ability (with prior agreement between Players and Story Guide), use it as an opportunity to roleplay that control. The Player under the control of Coyote's Gaze still has decision making power, they should just use it in a way that supports the mechanics of the Ability and creates an interesting story.

Deer's Smile

Activation: Primary Action, 1 point of Mind, 1 point of Soul

Dice Check: Charisma and Will

Your Character can project a soothing feeling, calming all within the sound of their voice range. Others will feel relaxed and peaceful and find it difficult to engage in any kind of violent conflict. How this presents varies. Some users sing or chant, others use a very specific tone and cadence of their speaking voice. Deer's Smile affects everyone within clear verbal range or everyone participating in an Encounter. It affects all beings, human, animal, creature, and spirit, unless otherwise noted.

To Activate this Ability, your Character spends a Primary Action(if in an Encounter) and 1 point of both Mind and Soul, and then performs a Dice Check based on a Pool of Charisma plus Will. The Success Number may be modified based on the relationship between the opponents at the Story Guide's discretion. The Character may not use Secondary Actions in the same Round they Activate the Ability. Deer's Smile lasts for a number of minutes equal to ten minutes for each Success achieved.

To take violent actions, targets of Deer's Smile must achieve more Successes on a Will check than

your Character did to Activate this Ability. This check is a Secondary Action. A violent action would be any action that costs others points of Body, Mind, or Soul, or could result in such. They must continue to make this Check each Round that they wish to take violent actions.

For the duration, Coercion, Charm, and Deception checks targeting those affected by Deer's Smile have their Success Number reduced by two.

Once the effect has worn off, if other people are aware that they had this Ability used on them against their will, they may get angry. Increase the Success Number of Coercion, Charm, and Deception attempts made by the Character against the targets by two.

Since this Ability doesn't fully block agency, but only encourages calm and peacefulness, it has not generated as much social backlash as something like Coyote's Gaze. It's looked upon as a helpful Ability within society for the most part. Nevertheless, its implications regarding consent cannot be dismissed out of hand. You may wish to discuss appropriate applications of this Ability prior to game play.

Will Abilities

Wolverine's Resolve

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Mind

Dice Check: Spirit and Endurance

Like the animal it is named after, this Ability makes your Character extremely tenacious during combat. Wolverine's Resolve can only be used during an Encounter. Your character can Activate this Ability with a Secondary action and a point of Mind. While active, the Character cannot be Stunned or rendered Unconscious. Once active, the Ability lasts until the end of the Encounter.

Any time the Character uses Fortitude during that Encounter, they may make a Reaction Roll from a Pool of Spirit and Endurance. The number of Successes gained is the amount of Soul they immediately regain. The maximum amount they may regain in this fashion is the amount they just spent, minus 1. For example, if they just spent 5 Soul on Fortitude, the maximum they could regain from the Reaction Roll would be 4.

At the end of the Encounter, the Character must reduce their Spirit

CHAPTER 9

by 1 until their next Long Rest. Keep in mind that means that if the Character ends the Encounter with only 1 Soul left, they'll end up with zero at the end of the Encounter, due to the Spirit loss, and wind up unconscious.

Spirit's Covenant

Activation: None

Dice Check: None

The Character is considered lucky, blessed, or cursed, depending on who you ask. How it is viewed, even by the Character themselves, varies — not everyone who has it enjoys this Ability. There's debate over how Spirit's Covenant works, which is hinted at by the name it has been given by the people of Cahokia. Some feel that it is a subtly aggressive psychic Ability similar to Wasp's Sting. Others feel this Ability is an indirect connection with a spirit, the spirit world, or The Black. The reason for that impression lies in its effect and how it is employed.

This Ability is always active and is applied to all rolls involving the Character, even when allies are

trying to provide a benefit to them. There is no known way to turn off or deactivate it. There are two game effects. The Character may ignore their first Fail during a Check, removing the one die from the Dice Pool.

Second, any time a Check is directed specifically at the Character with this Ability, whether by an ally or an enemy, any 2s that are rolled count as a Fail. This does not occur if they are part of a group effect or Check. These Fails may be modified by Focus.

There are people in Cahokia and abroad, among the more superstitious or less modern crowd, that feel the person with this Ability is tainted, dirty, or cursed. Some may feel strongly enough that they will avoid them or even actively despise them. Some people have even been ostracized by their family, clan, or tribe because of it. The situation is made worse by the fact that the owner of this Ability may not even realize they have it for quite some time and it's often others who begin to pick up on the Character's pattern of strange fortunes.

Owl's Watch

Activation: Secondary Action, 1 point of Mind

Dice Check: None

Owl's Watch is a preternatural power to respond reflexively to dangers and threats in a way that is beyond normal human ability. Unlike most other Abilities, it improves the Character's ability to react, rather than giving them new actions. It goes beyond just physical or observable dangers — your Character may not even always be aware of their defensive reactions.

During Narrative Play, the Player may Activate this Ability by spending 1 point of Mind. The Ability will last for one hour and may be maintained with another point of Mind each hour after that. While active, your Character cannot be Surprised. Instead in situations where they would have been Surprised, the effect is canceled and your Character gains a +2 bonus on their Initiative Score for the first Round. If the Character is required to make a Reaction Roll of any kind, they gain a -3 to their Success Number.

During an Encounter, your Character may spend 1 point of Mind and a Secondary Action to Acti-



vate Owl's Watch. From there, it is active until deactivated by your Character or the Encounter comes to an end. While active, your Character may add their Perception and Endurance to any Reaction Roll Dice Pools, in addition to whatever those Dice Pools originally call for.

While this Ability is active, the Character may not spend Mind on Focus without canceling the effect of Owl's Watch. If they do, the Ability is deactivated and must be reactivated with another Secondary Action and another point of Mind on the following Round.

Starting Equipment

Equipment and material goods in general don't have a specific cost in Coyote & Crow. Instead, their cost in nizi is represented in the game by a Cost Rank between 1 and 8. This Cost Rank is an abstraction, but it allows Players and Story Guides to more easily create a budget for your Character and group. For more on Cost Ranks and Wealth Ranks, see the Chapter Equipment as well as the Financial Gift and Burden in this Chapter.

When you are creating your Character, don't worry about making Wealth Checks for all of your items or being too concerned with what you are going to start with. Work with your Story Guide to craft a list of Gear that makes sense for your Character. Take into account your Archetype, your Background, Financial Gifts and Burdens and just go from there. Additionally, if it makes sense, the group may collectively have equipment that is shared. For example, maybe your whole saga is built around a group that owns a yutsu barge and the Characters are the crew. If that's the case, don't worry too much about the Cost Rank of a Yutsu Barge and

just make a note on your Character sheet that your group has one.

If you need more specific guidance, you can use this as a baseline:

- Characters can start with any number — within reason — of individual items that are below their Wealth Rank and
- They can start with three items equal to their Wealth Rank and
- They can start with one item equal to their Wealth Rank +1
- Starting gear shouldn't feel limiting or indulgent and should fit the theme of your story. Your Story Guide can set the budget for all Players, overriding the above suggestion.

Keep in mind that gear may affect Derived Stats for your Character, such as your Physical Defense while wearing armor. The sections of the book for the Story Guide will contain further suggestions for budgets for starting Characters and groups. Check the Chapter on Equipment for detailed descriptions and costs.

Derived Stats

Derived Stats are dependent on and are created from other Stats on your Character Sheet. Many change regularly through the course of gameplay based on what your Character is doing — whether they're injured, stressed, tired, or a myriad of other things. Any time something refers to a Derived Stat, it is referring to these kinds of values.

Now that we have all of your Character's other Stats figured out and they have some equipment, it's time to fill in the final numbers on your Character Sheet.

Initiative Score

A Character's Initiative Score is an indicator of how quickly they can choose to act during an Encounter. It is generally between 3 and 12, although it can go higher. It doesn't indicate who acts first, but instead who has the option of acting first. Initiative will be discussed in further detail in the Chapter detailing Encounters.

Your Character's Initiative Score is the sum of their Agility, Perception, and Charisma and can be modified by various factors, like Abilities, over the course of gameplay.

Your base Initiative Score is determined by adding:

$$\gg \text{Initiative Score} = \text{Agility} + \text{Perception} + \text{Charisma}$$

Defense Values

Physical, Mental, and Mystical Defense represent a Character's resistance within that category and are the default Success Numbers that another Character needs to achieve in order to affect your Character. Each of the three values is derived from a combination of the Finesse and Reserve Stat in each category added together.

$$\gg \text{Physical Defense} = \text{Agility} + \text{Endurance}$$

$$\gg \text{Mental Defense} = \text{Perception} + \text{Wisdom}$$

$$\gg \text{Mystical Defense} = \text{Charisma} + \text{Will}$$

Looking back at our definitions, the average Defense Stat should be about 5-6. There are also ways to modify this base number, including Abilities and equipment. These values represent both your Character's ability to avoid taking Damage in the first place as well as their ability to resist that Damage if they're unable to avoid it.

CHAPTER 9

Physical Defense represents your Character's ability to dodge, move quickly, think faster, and absorb and resist physical attacks.

Mental Defense represents their mental flexibility and psychic fortitude.

Mystical Defense represents their ability to deflect or avoid spiritual or magical attacks.

Body, Mind and Soul

Now you will determine your Character's Body, Mind, and Soul. These numbers are based on your Stats and will fluctuate during the game as your Character becomes injured, tired, or uses their Abilities. As such, you will want to record your baseline Body, Mind, and Soul, but be aware that during gameplay this number will often go up and down.

To determine your Character's normal maximum, add the following numbers together:

- » **Body = Strength + Agility + Endurance**
- » **Mind = Intelligence + Perception + Wisdom**
- » **Soul = Spirit + Charisma + Will**

Body

Body represents your Character's physical well-being, your overall state of material health. A knife wound damages Body, as does a long fall, a crash in a vehicle, or being exposed to temperature extremes.

If your Character is dropped to zero Body, they are rendered Unconscious. If they are damaged to the point that their Body is equal to the negative of their Character's Endurance, they die. For example, if a Character has an Endurance of 3, they will die if they reach -3 Body.

Mind

Mind represents your Character's ability to focus, be decisive, and take action. Unlike Body, your Character may spend Mind points voluntarily to help in other tasks. This mechanic is called Focus and will be discussed in detail in the Encounter Section.

When your Character's Mind drops to zero, they fall Unconscious. If they have a negative Mind equal to their Wisdom, they die.

A Character can lose Mind through using Focus, through being attacked by some Abilities, being subjected to some poisons, or through environmental or technological effects. Characters can regain Mind with Skills and Abilities as well as Long and Short Rests. Characters can also go above their normal maximum Mind for short periods, as described by their Abilities and Skills.

Soul

Soul represents your Character's deepest essence, their drive, and the strength of their link between worlds. If they drop to zero Soul, they fall Unconscious. If they drop to a negative Soul equal to their Will, they die. While Soul is a measure of how much mystical damage your Character can take, it can also be spent on the Fortitude mechanic, which will be explained further in the Encounter Section. Like Mind, Soul can temporarily go above the normal maximum with some effects and Abilities.



Background

From a numbers standpoint, your Character is finished. But looking at all of these descriptors and values written on your Character sheet, you probably feel like your Character is still incomplete. That is because people are more than just a column of adjectives and ranks. They need to have a story. In *Coyote & Crow*, you are going to be telling their story as you play, but that doesn't mean that they have to be a blank slate. Most heroes have humble beginnings and often have something that drives them to become the hero they are. For some it's aspirations, hopes, dreams. For others it's tragedy and sacrifice.

Now is the time to write your Character's background. You can use the small space on the Character sheet or write up a separate essay on them. When writing your Background, remember that you have two audiences: The Story Guide and your fellow Players. Maybe your Character grew up on a farm outside Cahokia and led a boring unremarkable life until the age of 17 when were thrust into a larger world. If that's their story, then you can write that, explain that to your Story Guide and fellow Players and be on your way.

But maybe you lost your partner to a strange illness, one that you may even be responsible for. Now that you have joined these other Characters, you don't mind them knowing that you are searching for a cure for this illness, but you don't want them to know that it took your partner and that you might be the cause. In that case, you might share portions of the story with the other Players and on your Character sheet, but communicate the secret parts to your Story Guide separately.

It's okay to make things up as you go as well. Don't feel like you have to know every detail of your Character as you play. Think of it like a television show. Sometimes, you will have a flashback episode in your mind and understand something completely new about your Character. That's great! Try to share those ideas as early as possible with the Story Guide. If you announce at the table mid-game that you have government forces searching for you, it might be hard for the Story Guide to incorporate that element on the fly.

Don't let the Background element overwhelm you. Take a look at your Gifts, Burdens, Path, Archetype, and Motivation. These

CHARACTERS

things are often enough to give you a sense of who this person is. Now all you have to do is give them a bit of description of how they came to be that person. What led someone to be a Seeker, on the Path of the Eagle, with a best friend who is their twin sister, and motivated by being a Protector?

If you're creating Characters in a group setting, feel free to use this opportunity to discuss your Character choices with the other Players. You can make group back-grounds if you like. Perhaps you are all siblings, on the same sports team, or are all part of a scientific research group.

In the end, Backgrounds are there to help you, your fellow Players, and your Story Guide get a better sense of who your Character is. It should be something that aids you in playing the game and not something that slows you down or boxes you in. There are no rules, mechanics, or effects to any background material, so go as light or as heavy as you feel comfortable with. Keep in mind that if you want an aspect of your Background to be significant enough that it has a mechanical effect, look into adding it as a Gift or Burden as well.



CHAPTER 9

Initial Goals

For more on Short and Long-Term Goals, see the section on Goals and Progress. When you create your Character, you will want to have some Long and Short-Term Goals ready to go before you play. You might want to wait to set these until right before your first Session or you may want to do it when you're creating your Character. In some cases, those two times will overlap. Regardless of when, it's important that your Character has a sense of direction and growth. What are they trying to accomplish?

Your Character can choose two Short-Term Goals and one Long-Term Goal, all of which are things they will be trying to achieve over the course of game play.

Succinctly, Short-Term Goals allow you to gain a Skill Rank in a current or new Skill or to buy something above your Wealth Rank without having to make a Check. For example, if you have Unarmed Combat Rank 2, and your Character wants to get better at that, they might choose Unarmed Combat as a Short-Term Goal. How you complete a Short-

Term Goal will be covered in the Goals and Progress Chapter.

Long-Term Goals are loftier and take longer to accomplish. They will also be detailed in the section on Goals and Progress. Long-Term Goals allow you to: Gain a Gift, lose a Burden, gain a Stat Point, gain an Ability, or acquire a piece of equipment two ranks above their Wealth Rank without making a Check. Simply write in what your Character wants to achieve as their Long-Term Goal and you're good to go.

Your Character can change their Goals at any time during game-play, so don't worry about it too much.

Names (and Naming Conventions)

The last thing you'll need to do to create your Character is give them a name. Because Cahokia is the center of continental trade, the names of Cahokians come from every corner of Makasing. That means that your Character's name might not perfectly match Cahokian spelling conventions (for more on these, please see the Chapter on Language and Communication). However, many Char-

CHARACTERS

acters will come from families who spoke Chahi as a first language, and their names will reflect that. Keep in mind, different cultures also have different customs for naming, with some preferring descriptive names that evoke a particular natural feature or animal. Other cultures prefer names that don't carry any meaning beyond the name itself, and are passed down from generation to generation. What is consistently true, however, is that names in Makasing do not follow a strict "first name, surname" pattern. Additionally, most names are non-gendered.

In Cahokia specifically, individuals will often have anywhere between three and four names. Children are typically assigned a name at birth. Some are given the name of their totem, place of birth, or a natural feature near the place they call home. In addition, many Cahokians will take on or more names over the course of their lives, which may be part of a tribal custom, an earned nickname, recognition as part of a specific achievement, or be taken on for a number of other reasons. At the start though, it's fine to just have a single name.

Below, find a few names common in modern-day Cahokia. You can also derive a name from the words listed in the Chahi glossary or visit our name generator at:

coyoteandcrow.net/chahi-name/

Kaya	Hala
Nampayo	Mawakii
Kanti	Kila
Genesee	Liwanu
Siik	Mansi
Dohasan	Adasi
Onawah	Sawni
Namid	Dichali
Tala	Takoda
Ohcomgachi	Una

Your Character is done and you're ready to play!

For Native players: Feel free to use names you know from your tribe or to extrapolate new spellings or meanings as you see fit.